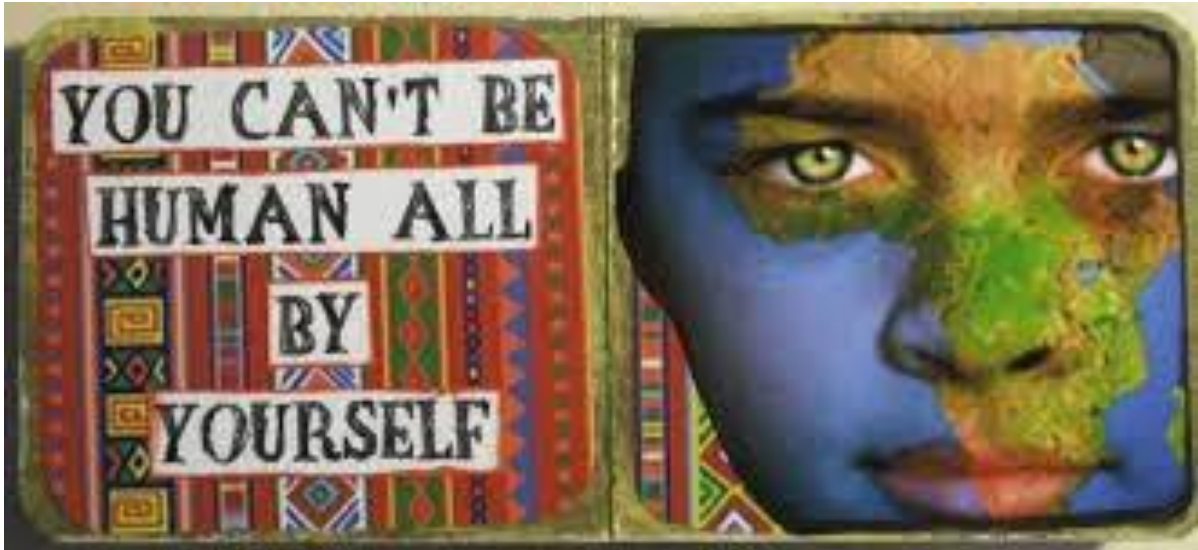


Strathmore University

Philosophical Anthropology notes



A. Kitawi© 2020

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Chapter 1

Introduction

I am sure some people are asking, why do I need to learn Philosophical Anthropology? Didn't I either chose Financial Economics, Bachelor's in Business and Information Technology, Bachelor's of Commerce, Bachelor of Laws, Bachelor's in Actuarial science? Where does a humanity fit in all this? This is a fair enough and valid question. Indeed, it is important such questions are asked.

The rationale for humanities is that, man is not only a practical being or economic being (*homo economicus*) but also a social being (*zoon politikon*). *Man is but the product of his thoughts what he thinks, he becomes (Mahatma Gandhi)*. The human person can be defined in different ways using a number of perspectives or points of view. I can define a human person in an economic way (rational economics), i.e. as a rational being who wishes to optimize choices open to him. Another way is to use a perspective borrowed from information technology, i.e. as a dynamic and complex system (systems' approach). A sociologist may define him either as a being determined by society (structuralist or functionalist perspective). These and many others provide an insight into man, albeit some more perfect than others. Nevertheless, there is need to define man in the most fundamental and radical way. The question of who is man cannot be separated from why does man exist. The only discipline that examines man in the most fundamental way is philosophy.

Philosophy and Philosophical Anthropology

Philosophy is the knowledge of all things through their ultimate causes, acquired through the use of reason. Other subjects look at proximate causes, but philosophy examines the ultimate or fundamental cause.

The proximate cause gives a narrower scope than the ultimate cause. These two terms can sound very confusing. Let us use another example: imagine a man sees an aeroplane/jet in the air. He then asks: what makes that jet a jet? Proximate causes can be: well it has a specific shape; some may say it has wings and an aero-dynamic body. All these are proximate ways of defining the jet but do not substantively define the plane. One needs a discipline which examines the fundamentals of a plane in order for one to define it in the right way. The same applies to anything concerning man. Before one examines man as a rational agent, an economic agent, as capital, as an ethical being, as a religious being or cultural being, it is important to examine who man is fundamentally. The only subject that examines man in his/her ultimate cause is Philosophical Anthropology. *The term Anthropology means study of man.*

This subject aims to give a deeper understanding of man (his ultimate cause) using a philosophical approach.

Definitions of some concepts used in Philosophical Anthropology

Philosophical Anthropology is a subject within the wide discipline of Philosophy, as such there is need to present important philosophical concepts before presenting anthropological concepts. Some of the important philosophical concepts are:

Philosophy

Philosophy is a term which can have different meanings. Some people ask, what is your philosophy of life? This is like asking: how do you view life? Some may say: I have a religious outlook on life (e.g. Christian, Muslim, Jewish or Hindu); other people may say the main aim of life is survival; while others view the main aim of life as happiness...

The term Philosophy, etymologically, originates from two words *Philo*, a Greek term which means love and *Sophia* is another term which means wisdom. Therefore when the two terms are combined in one concept it means love of wisdom. *This term is as ancient as the Greek civilization.* When Socrates was trying to find out who was the wisest person in Greece, he approached a number of people seeking wisdom, "Accordingly I went to one who had the reputation of wisdom, and observed to him - his name I need not mention; he was a politician whom I selected for examination - and the result was as follows: When I began to talk with him, I could not help thinking that he was not really wise, although he was thought wise by many, and wiser still by himself; and I went and tried to explain to him that he thought himself wise, but was not really wise; and the consequence was that he hated me, and his enmity was shared by several who were present and heard me. So I left him, saying to myself, as I went away: Well, although I do not suppose that either of us knows anything really beautiful and good, I am better off than he is - for he knows nothing, and thinks that he knows. I neither know nor think that I know... (Plato's *Apology*)"

The next question at issue is what is wisdom? Wisdom is linked to understanding (knowledge), not only just a superficial understanding but the understanding of the ultimate cause(s). People have linked this with practical wisdom which is prudence. Hence, Hippocrates referred to the wise as *sophronisteres* (self-controlled; prudent).

The definition of Philosophy is knowledge of all things through their ultimate causes, acquired through the use of reason (Artigas, 1984, pp. 3-10). *The most peculiar aspect of philosophy is that it grasps all things/all issues.* We can say that there is philosophy in medicine, information technology, economics, commerce, sociology, politics, law, religion...

All things in Philosophy are given a unique term, beings. *Philosophy is therefore the knowledge of all beings, through their ultimate cause(s), through the use of reason. The technical name of being is *ens*.*

Philosophy studies all beings using reason. We can state that the rational method is the tool employed in philosophy. It is therefore impossible for a person to be a philosopher if the person is not systematic or rational. A philosopher asks critical questions about beings: What makes this being? Why is it the way it is? Which are the aspects which make this being unique from another being? When was this being created?

The moment one states that philosophy studies all beings (objects), the second realization is that it has a specific method in examining all these objects and it uses fundamental principles. Philosophy is a science.

A science is characterized by: object; method; principles. The object is the ‘what’ of the study. The method is the ‘how’ and the principles are the fundamentals. What are the objects, methods and principles of Philosophy?

The object of Philosophy is all beings (*ens*). This is the matter, or what in technical term is referred to as, *material object of philosophy*. But how do we study all these beings, from the point of view of their ultimate cause? We can state that the aspect under which we study all beings or *formal object of philosophy is the ultimate cause (ontological underpinnings)*. In some books, ontological underpinnings is somewhat used in a synonymous way with metaphysical underpinnings.

Let us apply the above definition in a narrow way to the subject of Philosophical Anthropology. Like we mentioned before, anthropology refers to the study (logos) of man (anthropos). *Philosophical anthropology therefore studies one being-man, and not all beings*. The technical definition of **Philosophical anthropology is the knowledge of man through his/her ultimate cause, acquired through the use of reason.**

The *material object of Philosophical anthropology is man*, while the formal object is *his/her ontological (metaphysical) underpinnings*.

Man is a being. In Philosophy various philosophers have given different perspectives of being. Aristotle in his book the *Metaphysics (Book VII-Book X) and Categories* presents a number of these perspectives. Let us examine each perspective using the example of man (Alvira, Melendo, & Clavell, 1982); (Aristotle) *Categories (Section 1; Part 2-5)*:

a) *Being viewed from the aspect of transcendentals*

Transcendentals refers to that which surpasses all objects or beings. A transcendental can be applied to a material being, and yet the material being does not fully exhaust the term since it is not perfect. There are four transcendentals: a) Beauty; b) Unity; c) Goodness; d) Truth. *A person may say, Mary or Diana is beautiful*. When a person says this, he does not mean that other people are not beautiful. He may meet another being who is more beautiful than Mary or Diana. We can say that this transcendental term surpasses the object or being called Diana. The other transcendentals are: *unity which means a being is one; goodness which means a being is desirable; truth which means that whatever I have in my mind corresponds to reality; beauty which means it is pleasing to behold*. In many situations, when you say that something is beautiful you may also imply that it is good.

b) *Being viewed from the perspective of substance and accidents*

What is a substance and what is an accident? Substance technically refers to that which stands under (sub-under; stance). Substance is what primarily supports or defines a thing. When a person is trying to differentiate a man from a cat, he will first try to do so looking at what is primary and cannot be applied to the cat. This is, he has a human body and human soul which has an intellect and will. The body of the cat is different from that of a human being and the same applies to the soul. Hence the core of a human person, what is primary, what defines man as man is the human body and human soul with intellect and will. *An accident in philosophy is not something like a collision*. Accidents refer to the secondary characteristics. The body and soul have specific secondary characteristics. Tom’s body may have a specific complexion, height, weight and is son of specific parents. We can say that complexion, height and weight are secondary characteristics.

In Aristotelian Philosophy there are nine accidents: Quality; Quantity; Relation; Place; Position; Possession; Time; Action; Passion. Mary is a beautiful girl (quality). She is 70kgs (quantity). She is the daughter of Anastacia (Relation). She is in the university (place). She is sitting next to Jane (position). She has a laptop (possession). She is eating (action) the apple (passion) because it is 1pm (time). All the nine accidents are secondary and do not primarily determine Mary's human nature.

c) *Being examined from the point of view of act and potency*

The term act has been implicitly referred to under the nine accidents. Nevertheless, it is a specific way of characterizing being. The term being comes from the word to be. When something is, i.e. in existence, we say it is a be-ing (be in continuous form). This being in existence has an act. Either something is or is not. Alfred is living or is not living. We can say Alfred is in the act of existence, after eighty years he will not be in existence. Alfred is in act, the act of living. Forty-five years ago, Alfred was not in existence but as long as his parents were living, he had the possibility (potency) of coming into existence.

Act is therefore a perfection of a being, while potency refers the ability to receive perfection. Potencies can be active or passive. Alfred, since he is a human being, has the capacity to think (active potency), but he may not be thinking at the moment (passive potency).

d) *Being examined from the perspective of matter and form*

These two terms matter and form are subjects of great concern in sciences, especially the Biological sciences. There is a tendency to reduce everything into matter, including the differences in beings. While, if we examine it rationally, we can deduce other things which are not material and are part of the world of beings. Matter is proper to all corporeal beings. It in its pure form it is indeterminate, i.e. not some-thing. What determines it is the form. *We can state that form is that which actuates matter.* The form of the human being is the soul while the matter is the body. Without the form, the human body is not that thing called the human person.

e) *Being approached from act of being and manner of being*

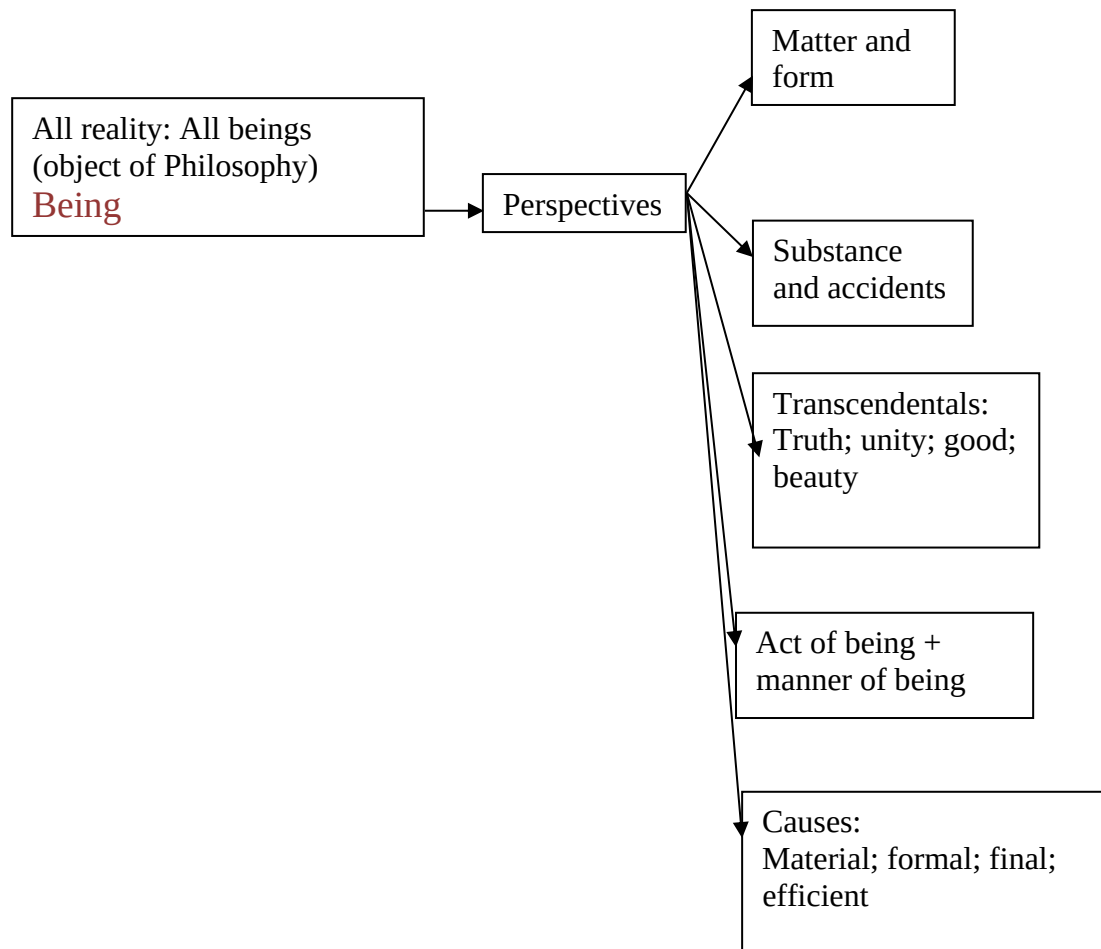
Act of being is similar to form. *The technical name of act of being is esse.* Man's act of being makes him live, breathe and do all actions which are termed as 'life' actions. *Manner of being refers to how something is in reality. Its technical name is essentia.* *The manner of being of man is human. Man is human.* If we are to represent Being in terms of act of being and manner of being it is: Being (ens)= esse + essentia. In terms of perfection, a being is perfect depending on the act of being. Man is the most perfect of all living things because he shows higher and complex acts of being compared to other living material beings. These actions are thinking and loving.

f) *Being from the perspective of causes*

Science refers to the study of specific things through causes. *For every effect, in the corporeal universe, there is a cause.* If someone spots a mango on the ground and he is told that it just appeared, it will be naïve to accept such an explanation. For a mango to be on the ground there has to be a cause for the mango to be a mango and for it to be in a specific place on the ground. Similarly, we can say for man, the being can be approached from a number of causes.

There are four causes: **the material cause which refers to what something is made out of; the efficient cause is who makes a particular being; final cause is the purpose or end of a being; formal cause is that which actualizes a thing.** If we apply these four causes to man, man's matter is the body; the efficient cause is the creator and the parents; the final cause is truth and consequently happiness, what Aristotle refers to as *Eudaimonia*; the formal cause is the soul of man.

As mentioned earlier, Philosophy is a science because it has the object, method and principles. The method is logic/reason. But what are its principles?



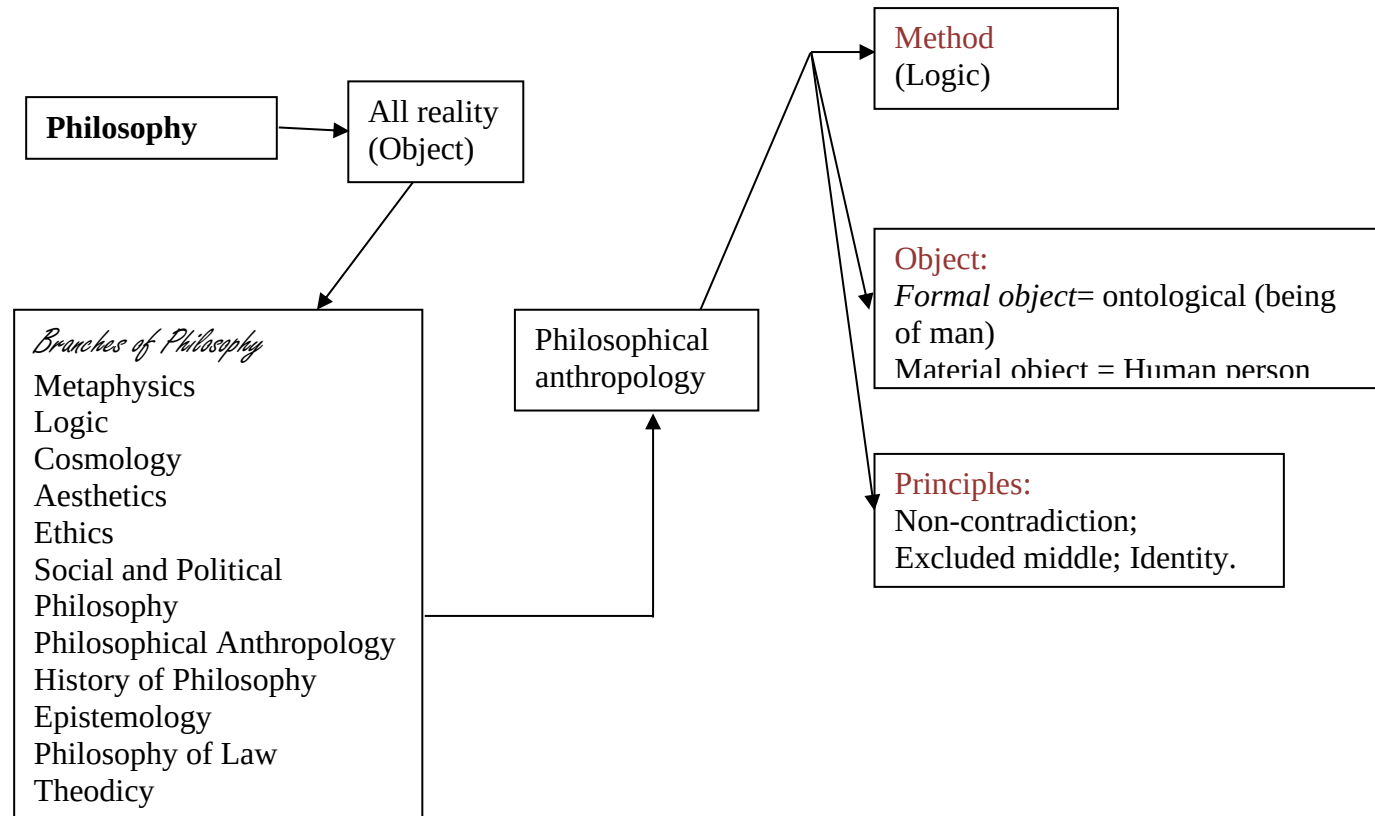
Principles of Philosophical Anthropology

Principles refer to fundamental assumptions. Principles of accounting refer to fundamental assumptions used in accounting and are used when preparing books of accounts e.g. going concern, realization... Principles of economics are those rational assumptions taken either in the field of rational or behavioural economics and are used to explain how man allocates scarce resources e.g. pareto efficiency. If the fundamental assumptions are wrong, then the arguments and the conclusions drawn in that study will be incorrect.

Principles of Philosophy are applied to all other branches of Philosophy including Philosophical Anthropology. ***The amazing fact is that these same principles are also used in all sciences, whether social, physical or biological.*** There are three principles:

- i) *Principle of non-contradiction-* This principle states that beings cannot be self-contradictory. It can be rephrased as, it is impossible for something to be and not to be in the same manner, time and respect. It is the first law of logic and is naturally and spontaneously known by all men. Alfred, who is a man, cannot be a plane or a bird (in the same manner) and at the same time human.
- ii) *Principle of excluded middle-* The principle states that there is no middle ground between being and non-being. If Philip is in a coma or a vegetative state, one cannot say he is not alive. It is either he is alive or not alive.
- iii) *Principle of identity-* This principle is closely linked to the principle of non-contradiction. It states that something is, what it is. Although neither Thomas Aquinas speaks of identity as a first principle, many neo-scholastic authors mention it, almost always reducing it to the principle of non-contradiction.

Concept summarizing Philosophy and Philosophical Anthropology as Science



After presenting the fundamental concepts, the next step is to rationalize the subject itself. Why do I need to study Philosophical Anthropology? Is it beneficial? To answer this question, I would like to reiterate a point earlier mentioned. In any society, when a person is dealing with other men, one's view of a human person will determine how he allocates resources (economics), relates with others (sociology/human relations), considers what is right or wrong (ethics), determines the political order (political science) or even how one worships (religion). Let us give an example, *assume I am a person who considers man purely from an economic perspective, i.e., only as a factor of production*. I will allocate resources to those men who will enable me to produce the most items, consequently I will relate with those people who will enable me to get as many factors of production as possible and what is right becomes what is economically beneficial. In such a situation one will eliminate the people with feeble minds, e.g., people who are mentally unstable or those with weak/fragile bodies. *We need therefore to have a correct understanding of man.*

We can therefore state that the benefits of the subject are:

- a) It provides an in-depth understanding about human nature and different operations necessary to formulate principles and content for the various disciplines.
- b) It explains the nature, value and dignity of man philosophically, which is necessary for scientific, legal and political development.
- c) It facilitates the evaluation of different human societies and different inter- personal relations that arise from these societies.
- d) It explains the fundamental aspects of a human person, i.e., his/her thinking and loving and how these two relate to other fields/disciplines.
- e) It enables a critical evaluation of the destiny of the human person.
- f) It provides a basis for understanding morality, and consequently ground morality on virtues which control the appetites and faculties.

In this subject, we shall use the metaphysical approach to Philosophical Anthropology. The metaphysical approach examines man systematically from his ontological underpinnings.

Other approaches or perspectives to the subject are: cultural perspective (cultural anthropology) which examines man as a product of society and a maker of history and culture; transcendental anthropology examines man in his most radical actions, i.e. his thinking and loving actions; religious anthropology examines man as a being who looks up to God (*religion from re-ligare*) and binds himself to a supreme Being. I will use only the metaphysical approach.

Before indulging in the next few topics, it may be important to provide an overview of how man was viewed during different eras.

Historical anthropological keys

During the period of the ancients (the term ancients refer to classical Greece), the anthropological insistence was to view man as a being that has certain features or characteristics-having a body and soul; matter and form; act of being and manner of being. This borrows much from *Aristotelian Metaphysics*.

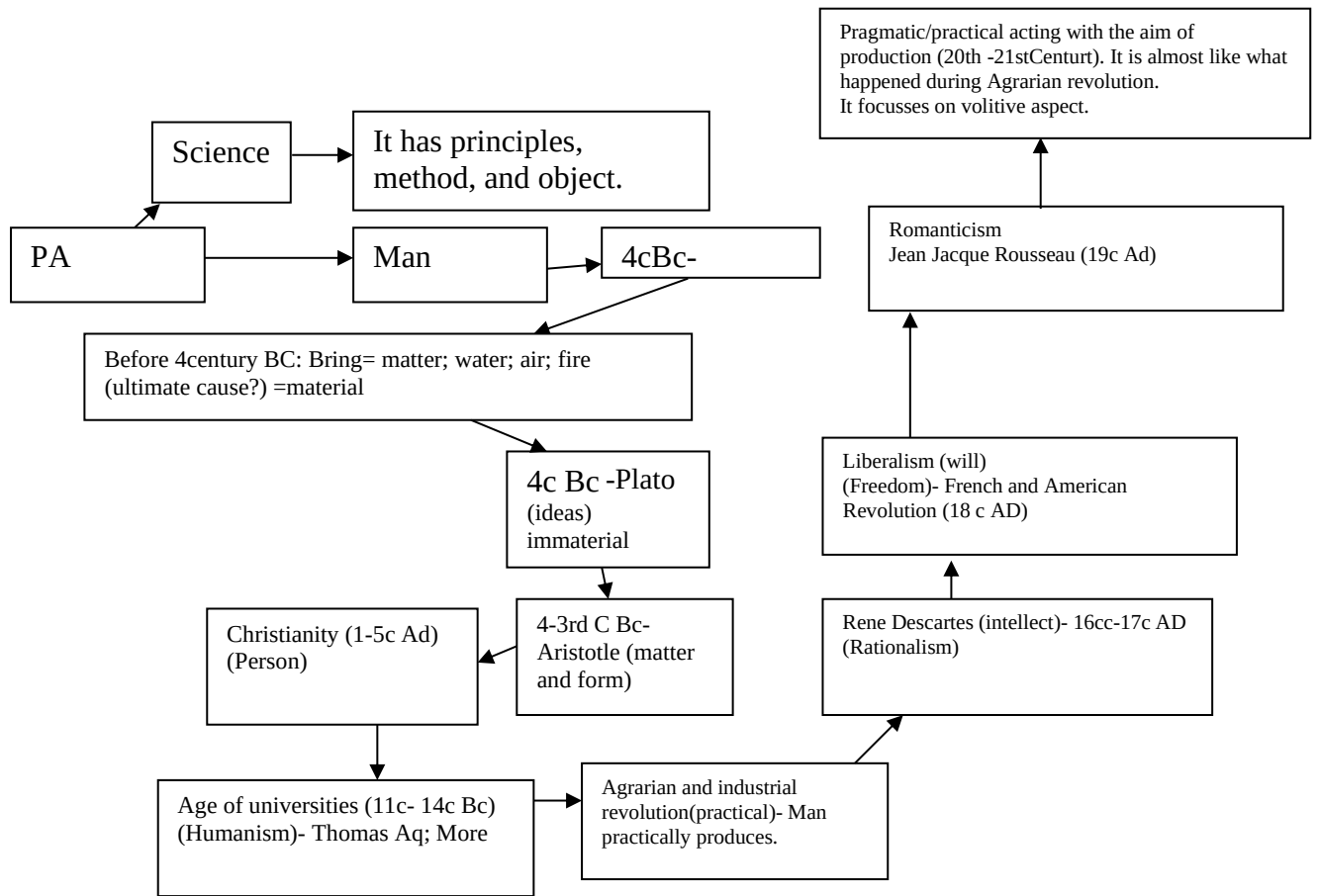
At the birth of Christianity this insistence radically changed to viewing man as a person (emerging from the notion of God as a Trinity of Persons). Man is a person who relates with a supreme creator. There was thus a need to have that personal relation with him; in the middle-

ages, referring to the 8/9th century until the 14th Century, philosophers viewed man from the perspective of being (grounding Philosophy in an Aristotelian sense). During the low middle ages, i.e. at the dawn of humanism and renaissance (14th-16th Century), man was viewed from the perspective of practical acting [*refer to Agrarian, Copernican and Industrial revolutions*]. It is important to note that at this stage there was a radical shift from Theocentrism (God Centred) Anthropology to Human centism (man-cantered). The most evident function of man, if one centres on a human person and not Theocentrism, is his/her practical acts (*industrial production*).

At the dawn of rationalism (the age where reason reigned supreme-18th to 19th centuries), the focus changed to the intellectual actions of man, i.e. man was viewed as a rational acting being. This was also the time when the Encyclopaedia was invented and at the end was marked by the French and American Revolutions. In the 19th Century, there was a gradual shift. The emphasis was on the actions of the will, i.e. his volitive acts (free acts). Freedom and political theory developed substantially during this era due to the insistence on will to choose.

The latest currents look at man as a unit of production, productive acting, with consequent reductionist philosophies like *utilitarianism, existentialism, positivism and materialism*.

Different Anthropological keys in Philosophy



Chapter 2

Alive!

It is interesting that there are different forms of life. There are plants, animals and man. Another interesting aspect is there are different varieties in each of these categories. *In the observation of life, a number of questions arise: what is life? Where does life come from? What makes us categorize these particular forms of life in the different groups? What makes life to be life? When do you say that something has life? Are there any grades in the examination of life and what is the cause of gradation?*

The aforementioned questions can be answered in a variety of ways, from the perspective of the natural sciences or philosophy. We shall answer these questions using the philosophical approach.

What is life?

Is life a purely biological issue? Isn't life material and a change in processes? Does life evolve from matter or is there something different other than matter that is the principle of life?

Life is an act, a certain power which produces specific secondary actions. All living bodies show specific common characteristics: *they grow, reproduce, excrete and feed (nutrition)*. All these are actions which show life but these actions are not life. We can term these actions consequential; they follow a certain principle, an act or primary form. The growth in size of a plant does not mean a growth in primary form or principle. What the outward growth in size presents is that there is something which is causing the physical growth; quantifiable growth. This is what Aristotle refers to as the form.

The principle of life is the soul. *The soul is the form of the body.* Without the soul a living being is dead. It cannot grow, respire, reproduce...

On the other hand, we see various forms of life. There are plants, animals and man. Plants do not have senses but animals do. In the case of man, we realize that he has senses and also other faculties which are proper to man, i.e. the intellect and the will. These two aspects will be discussed in later topics.

We can therefore explain life as the state of possessing a soul. The soul enables all corporeal living bodies (i.e. plants, animals and men) to:

- i) ***Have unity.*** The action of digestion achieves its purpose which is the nutrition and health of the species because there is an organizing and unifying principle responsible for this act. If this were not the case, then once an animal ingests food, it would not always follow that digestion will take place. The same applies to other actions like seeing, hearing... The soul is the principle of unity in a being.
- ii) ***Be able to move or grow:*** The secondary action of growth, and other internal movements within the being that enable its growth, are made possible because of a soul.
- iii) ***Present rhythm:*** Plants, animals and men show rhythm-specific cycles. The being is born through various forms of reproduction, then it grows and eventually it dies. The principle responsible for preserving and maintaining this kind of rhythm is the soul.
- iv) ***Perform intrinsic actions or immanent actions:*** intrinsic actions are actions which are not external but internal to the agent. The actions of seeing, feeling, growth,

reproduction all take place within a being. These immanent actions are preserved by a specific foundation, a principle called the soul.

We can state that the soul has to inhere in each part of a living organism to facilitate the actions described (in i-iv) above. If the soul is not in the ear, the ear decomposes or corrupts. If the soul ceases to exist in a specific organ, that organ has to be separated from the body otherwise it infects the whole body; it is a danger to the body.

Where does life come from?

The question where does life come from is really puzzling. We have explained that the soul is the form or act of the body. For something to give an act it has to be in act. The soul (act) cannot be given by something which is potency or in potency. We can thus make a deduction that the origin of life has to be an act.

“Now it is clear that the first thing by which the body lives is the soul. And as life appears through various operations in different degrees of living things, that whereby we primarily perform each of all these vital actions is the soul. For the soul is the primary principle of our nourishment, sensation, and local movement; and likewise of our understanding.” (Summa Theologica, First Part, Question 76, Article 1)

But which act is it in the case of the human person? This issue will be covered in the topic of the origin of the human person.

Whether the soul is material

Is the soul material since it inheres in every living part? To answer this question, let us present an objection presented by Thomas Aquinas in his writing the *The Summa Theologica Part 1*. Thomas Aquinas uses the common Socratic Questioning in order to provide answers to fundamental questions. The method is to present the question at issue, provide different perspectives, analyze the arguments given in the perspectives and then provide a conclusion or answer to the controversy.

Summa Theologica, First Part, Question 75, Article 1

Question at issue: Whether the soul is a body?

Objection 1(perspective 1): It would seem that the soul is a body. For the soul is the moving principle of the body. Nor does it move unless moved. First, because seemingly nothing can move unless it is itself moved, since nothing gives what it has not; for instance, what is not hot does not give heat. Secondly, because if there be anything that moves and is not moved, it must be the cause of eternal, unchanging movement, as we find proved Phys. viii, 6; and this does not appear to be the case in the movement of an animal, which is caused by the soul. Therefore the soul is a mover moved. But every mover moved is a body. Therefore the soul is a body.

Analysis and answer to objection: “As everything which is in motion must be moved by something else, a process which cannot be prolonged indefinitely, we must allow that not every mover is moved. For, since to be moved is to pass from potentiality to actuality, the mover gives what it has to the thing moved, inasmuch as it causes it to be in act. But, as is shown in Phys. viii, 6, there is

a mover which is altogether immovable, and not moved either essentially, or accidentally; and such a mover can cause an invariable movement. There is, however, another kind of mover, which, though not moved essentially, is moved accidentally; and for this reason it does not cause an invariable movement; such a mover, is the soul. There is, again, another mover, which is moved essentially—namely, the body. And because the philosophers of old believed that nothing existed but bodies, they maintained that every mover is moved; and that the soul is moved directly, and is a body.”

Conclusion: *“To seek the nature of the soul, we must premise that the soul is defined as the first principle of life of those things which live: for we call living things "animate," [*i.e. having a soul], and those things which have no life, "inanimate." Now life is shown principally by two actions, knowledge and movement. The philosophers of old, not being able to rise above their imagination, supposed that the principle of these actions was something corporeal: for they asserted that only bodies were real things; and that what is not corporeal is nothing: hence they maintained that the soul is something corporeal. This opinion can be proved to be false in many ways; but we shall make use of only one proof, based on universal and certain principles, which shows clearly that the soul is not a body.”*

“It is manifest that not every principle of vital action is a soul, for then the eye would be a soul, as it is a principle of vision; and the same might be applied to the other instruments of the soul: but it is the "first" principle of life, which we call the soul. Now, though a body may be a principle of life, or to be a living thing, as the heart is a principle of life in an animal, yet nothing corporeal can be the first principle of life. For it is clear that to be a principle of life, or to be a living thing, does not belong to a body as such; since, if that were the case, every body would be a living thing, or a principle of life. Therefore a body is competent to be a living thing or even a principle of life, as "such" a body. Now that it is actually such a body, it owes to some principle which is called its act. Therefore the soul, which is the first principle of life, is not a body, but the act of a body; thus heat, which is the principle of calefaction, is not a body, but an act of a body.”

The soul is therefore not a body but the form of the body. In nature, we also observe that we have different types of beings; there are plants, animals and men.

Can we thus conclude that the forms of these bodies are the same since all have life?

Let us examine each in a systematic manner. Plants present four fundamental characteristics: they grow, respire, reproduce and excrete. They nevertheless do not have senses. Animals show the four fundamental characteristics in addition to the senses. An animal has the external senses of sight, smell, hearing, touching and tasting. Note in the aforementioned statement I choose to use senses and not sense organs. Sense organs are material while sight, smell and hearing are powers, or phrased in another way actions which the soul performs. For the powers to act, we need the sensory organs to perceive specific sensibles (Aristotle, *On sense and the sensible*).

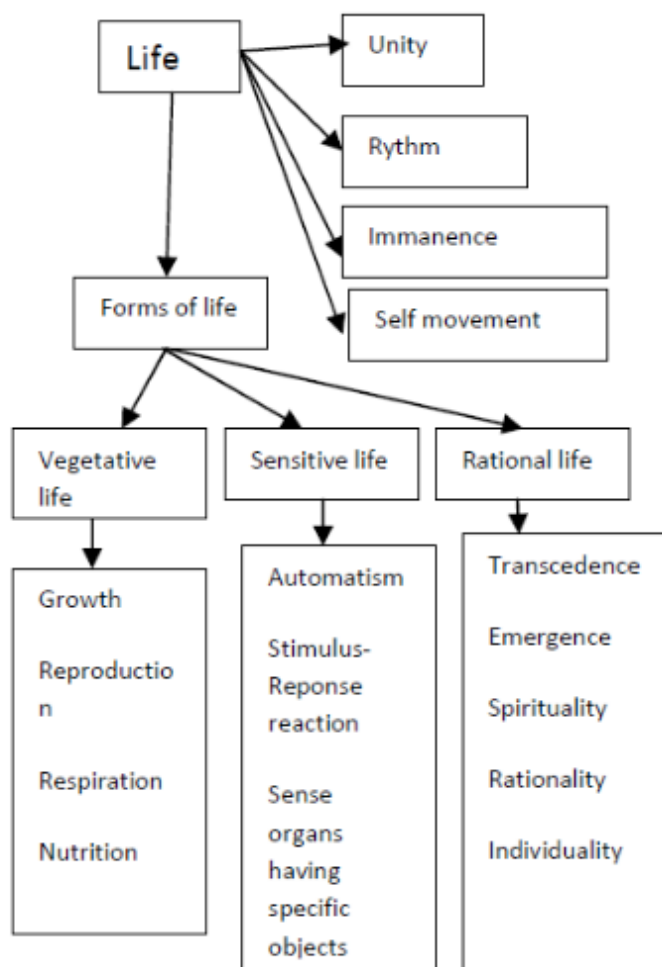
The external senses work in tandem with the internal senses: the common sense unifies the common sensibles (colour, odour, texture). Thus a person is able to determine that a white Subaru makes a specific noise; the imagination, which is an internal sense, forms the image of the Subaru in the brain. We thus have the subjective knowledge, the Subaru (image) in the brain of the objective car (Subaru) outside the brain; the other internal sense is the memory which is responsible for storing the images produced. If we do not have this internal sense, then we will not be able to remember things. The memory is divided into three parts, the sense registers which records everything, the short term memory which preserves recollections for a short period and the long term memory which preserves recollections for years and decades. The memory of a sentient being can be trained; the fourth internal sense is the estimative sense or sixth sense. This sense is responsible for preserving the life of the organism. It is the sense of self preservation. It enables a sentient being place the external world in relation to itself. Thus if a fire is perceived by the eyes and the image formed in the imagination, the being runs for its dear life because it knows that it can end its existence. In man, this sense is called the cogitative sense and not the estimative sense. The action of the intellect, which is not material, tries to rationalize an external reality in relation to itself. The man therefore can break the stimulus response reaction. It does not follow that a man will always run when he/she sees fire (stimulus-response). He may decide I can stop this fire by using a fire extinguisher.

In the above example we can infer three forms of life: **plant life referred to as vegetative life; animal life which is synonymous with sentient life; human life which is also called rational or spiritual life**. The main emphasis in this subject is rational life. This form of life will have its own topic because it is our main concern. The different types of souls are the causes of gradation. Plant life is less perfect than animal life. Animal life is less perfect than human life. The act of being of man is the highest, most perfect, most beautiful and the best amongst corporeal living beings.

In conclusion life is shown through four specific characteristics: unity, immanence, rhythm and self-movement. Plant life shows vegetative functions: growth, reproduction, nutrition and excretion. Animal life presents three distinguishing characteristics: automatism which means that these beings move from one location to another; present a clear stimulus response reaction due to the external and internal senses; each animal sense has a specific object which it perceives e.g. smell in the case of the nose. Human life is different from plant and animal life.

The soul of a plant is called the vegetative soul. The soul of an animal is the sentient or animal soul. The human soul is the rational or spiritual soul.

Concept map for life



Chapter 3

Are we human? [Human life]

History presents us with a number of cases where people ask the fundamental question: what makes us human? Hitler, resounding superficially Nietzsche's ideology of the superhuman, thought that some individuals are more human than others- *superhuman*. Hitler thought that if this was the case, then it would be better to build a whole political, economic, and social system based on such a category. Somehow, we see similar examples mirrored in places where there is genocide, wars or other forms of social conflicts. Some men can think that race is what makes a person human. For such men one race is higher than the other. In other cases, people can base it on religious, ethnic, clan or tribal issues. But are these people accurate in their analysis?

When a man is born, we observe that he has specific accidents. A person has a specific colour, weight, height, is the son or daughter of a rich person or a pauper and has certain physical abilities or disabilities. Can we use a person's colour, weight, or height to categorize or characterize humans?

To answer the above question, we must ask, what makes us human? What is at the core of human nature? ***Man is a hylomorphic being, i.e., he has a body and a soul.*** The body is matter and the soul is its substantial form. What makes Alice, Alfred, Diana, Philip, Anastacia members of the human race is the fact that they have a body and a soul.

The body has specific characteristics or secondary determinants e.g., weight, height or colour. We cannot separate the soul (form) of a human person from the fact that he/she has the intellect and will. There are evidence which show men have an intellect and will. These will be discussed later. The secondary determinants of the soul will be that a person has a certain IQ or makes specific choices. The IQ and choices follow the fact that he is a living being. In this case, it does not make sense to hinge the identity of the human being on accidents like weight, height, colour, action, passions and even relations.

Am I the only free and intelligent being?

The question am I the only free and intelligent being can only be asked and answered by a rational being (*a being that is capable of formulating arguments*).

Man discovers that certain animals like apes, are capable of mimicking actions which man does. Some animals like dogs bury bones and later may dig out the bone. A parrot can mimic certain phrases that a human being mentions. But does this make these animals intelligent?

Intelligence is the capacity to read into the nature of things (*intus-legere*). Man is capable of saying the 'I'. Man is self-aware. *I know that I know, or I know that I don't know*. If I ask the question, am I the only free and intelligent being, I imply I am aware that I exist and I am aware that I am asking the question. In addition, I understand specific concepts like freedom and intelligence. The concepts I, intelligence and freedom are not material but are abstract concepts representing what I experience in reality. Intelligence is the ability to abstract, to read into the nature of issues and freedom refers to the ability of making choices without coercion. These concepts are not material but are immaterial. Human language is used to express concepts. Therefore, a man understands the meaning of words. Man is a creature that searches

for meaning and his/her expressions have meaning. Other sentient animals don't know that they know, and they cannot abstract concepts. Formulation of concepts is the first step in innovation. Animal 'language' is purely sensitive and is limited to its own existence. Man's language can and does transcend his existence. This means that it will be a gross error to equate a human being with another sentient animal.

The soul of a human being does not rely purely on instinct. If I feel scared or endangered when I enter a certain place, which is due to the sixth sense, I do not stop there. I ask, what made me feel this? I want to know, to explain that inner feeling I have. I am also a thinking (*Homo Sapiens*), knowing and loving being.

It is therefore correct to refer to ***a human being as a psychosomatic being. A being with a body (soma) and soul (psyche).*** The human being is aware of his own existence. I am aware I am a human person. ***The term person has been defined by Boethius as an individual substance of a rational nature.*** As mentioned before, I am aware that I exist; I am unique and different from another person; *I am an individual. I also think (rational) and I subsist (substance).*

We shall examine in later chapters what is the object of the intellect and the will, how they function and how this connects with their corporeality. Let us examine two concepts which form the substance of man: the human body and the human soul.

My human body (my somatic aspect)

The human body is a complex system. Despite the fact that scientists have been able to sequence the genetic code, we have never been able to understand completely how the human body functions, the cause of some diseases... The body is not a living entity before receiving life. Without life, physical realities are not an organic body, but inert matter. The organs are biological props for the powers or faculties with which the living body is endowed: the ears are the organs of hearing, the eyes of vision (Selles, 2010, p. 76). We need the ears to hear. Hearing is a power. We need the eyes to see. Seeing is a power. But the body depends on the soul which is the first act of the body. The soul enables the body to function.

The human body with its functions and faculties constitutes human nature. We receive our body from our parents. Our parents give us the body but they do not give us our personhood. Our personhood comes from the act of being. I am Alfred because I think in a particular way and make particular choices which are due to the human soul (*my substantial form*). It is true that the brain and human body comes from my parents, but how I think and choose is something proper to me as an individual. The choices and thought process do not have an organic basis, i.e. my freedom and thinking is not something physical or material. This means it is not only the body that thinks and chooses.

When we are born, we are born naked. Man discovers that his body is without clothing. I am aware that I exist and that I am naked. Furthermore, I am aware that I should not be naked. *It is interesting to note that man is the only corporeal being who is aware that she/he is born naked and needs to cover her/his nakedness.* We can therefore state that the act of covering our nakedness is something intellectual and we do it willingly (choice). The act of clothing is a human action and not an animal act. In addition to the individual meaning of dressing, dressing can have a cultural or spiritual significance. To neglect dressing denotes a lessening of our human nature. It is a loss of virtue- it is unethical.

The human body is a great gift, an immense wealth, but limited. Biological deficiencies, bodily needs, etc. can be solved by thinking. But even here there are limitations, for death is an insuperable limit to the body. With his body man can do all that animals can, but not exclusively with it. Reason empowers him to extend or modify its functions (Selles, 2010, p.79).

The structure of the body is also different. Aristotle in his book *on the Gait of animals* shows the features of different animals and how the respective adaptations help each species. The human body is also structured in a particular way to enable it perform human actions and not merely biological actions. The human body has been structured to think, to choose, to work and to love.

The parts of the human body differ more than the rest from the equivalent animal ones. Aristotle called the human hand “tool of all tools,” because with them we can do practically everything. Their most expressive thing is to show acceptance, as when dad hugs, mum rocks the cradle, etc (Selles, 2010). The touch of a human being is very distinct from that of other animals. The hands can express many things. My handshake can express love or that I despise another person. The hands of a pianist, for instance, express the feelings of the artist; what he thinks and what he loves. Their gestures are very significant, and admit no end of modalities.

My personal combined facial features can express joy, sadness, pain, anger, etc. The lips speak and smile. Our teeth are not specialized for tearing or chewing the cud, but can eat anything, help the speech, etc. The neck is endowed with normal movements, neither too rapid like those of birds, which would hinder thinking, nor tardy like the chameleon’s, for that would hinder our adapting to the environment. Our tongue is not heavy, like the camel’s, or narrow and thin like the serpent’s, for us to articulate our voice. The muscles of the cheek cover a good portion of the mandible, so that the size of the mouth is not excessive, as in reptiles, and enables one to manifest many states of mind. These muscles, however, are light, so as to permit speaking, smiling, communicating sadness, anguish and pain. The skull is positioned vertically over the vertebral column, so as to look ahead. In quadrupeds its position is horizontal in respect of the body, so as to look down to the ground, where they find food and habitat. In us, the brain occupies the greater part of the volume of the skull; in animals it occupies a smaller part, as in horses, dogs, etc. The human brain also has free neurons, i.e. without a fixed function like innervating the stomach, the eyes etc. Man is also the only animal that takes care of the hair, by combing (Selles, 2010, p.80).

Other human traits are crying, expressing acceptance, rejection, anger, sadness, pain, tenderness, etc. Strictly speaking all the facets of the human spirit can shine through the face. Not to manifest them indicates rigidity, lack of freedom of spirit, simulation, duplicity, lies... *Man has to manifest what is in his/her soul sincerely.* All facial expressions are designed to appeal to others. No animal sends messages with its face. The face also expresses a number of feelings and thoughts. We can know what is in the soul by looking at the face and the eyes. *The eyes are the mirror of the soul and reflect everything that seems to be hidden; and like a mirror, they also reflect the person looking into them. (Paulo Coelho)*. If the soul is well the body dances. It does not follow that if the body is well the soul dances, or is happy. This means that the soul, though immaterial and not visible, is superior to the body.

My Human soul (my psyche)

The human soul is not visible. Is my soul in my fingers, in my mind and in my legs when I am alive? The answer is yes. The soul vivifies each and every part of the human person. This does not mean that we have many souls (multiplicity of souls). We have one soul, which as we inferred to earlier is the principle of life. If my hand is separated from my body, it does not follow that I have less of my human soul. The human soul is not material; it cannot be divided.

Thomas Aquinas phrases it succinctly in The first part of the Summa Theologica, Question 76, Article 3:

Question: Whether besides the intellectual soul there are in man other souls essentially different from one another?

Objection: It would seem that besides the intellectual soul there are in man other souls essentially different from one another, such as the sensitive soul and the nutritive soul. For corruptible and incorruptible are not of the same substance. But the intellectual soul is incorruptible; whereas the other souls, as the sensitive and the nutritive, are corruptible, as was shown above (Question [75], Article [6]). Therefore in man the essence of the intellectual soul, the sensitive soul, and the nutritive soul, cannot be the same.

Analysis of the objection (arguments): The sensitive soul is incorruptible, not by reason of its being sensitive, but by reason of its being intellectual. When, therefore, a soul is sensitive only, it is corruptible; but when with sensibility it has also intellectuality, it is incorruptible. For although sensibility does not give incorruptibility, yet it cannot deprive intellectuality of its incorruptibility.

Conclusion: Plato held that there were several souls in one body, distinct even as to organs, to which souls he referred the different vital actions, saying that the nutritive power is in the liver, the concupiscible in the heart, and the power of knowledge in the brain. Which opinion is rejected by Aristotle (De Anima ii, 2), with regard to those parts of the soul which use corporeal organs; for this reason, that in those animals which continue to live when they have been divided in each part are observed the operations of the soul, as sense and appetite. Now this would not be the case if the various principles of the soul's operations were essentially different, and distributed in the various parts of the body. But with regard to the intellectual part, he seems to leave it in doubt whether it be "only logically" distinct from the other parts of the soul, "or also locally."

In the first place, an animal would not be absolutely one, in which there were several souls. For nothing is absolutely one except by one form, by which a thing has existence: because a thing has from the same source both existence and unity; and therefore things which are denominated by various forms are not absolutely one; as, for instance, "a white man." If, therefore, man were 'living' by one form, the vegetative soul, and 'animal' by another form, the sensitive soul, and "man" by another form, the intellectual soul, it would follow that man is not absolutely one. Thus Aristotle argues,

Metaph. viii (Did. vii, 6), against Plato, that if the idea of an animal is distinct from the idea of a biped, then a biped animal is not absolutely one. For this reason, against those who hold that there are several souls in the body, he asks (De Anima i, 5), "what contains them?"—that is, what makes them one? It cannot be said that they are united by the one body; because rather does the soul contain the body and make it one, than the reverse.

*We must therefore conclude that in man the sensitive soul, the intellectual soul, and the nutritive soul are numerically one soul. This can easily be explained, if we consider the differences of species and forms. For we observe that the species and forms of things differ from one another, as the perfect and imperfect; as in the order of things, the animate are more perfect than the inanimate, and animals more perfect than plants, and man than brute animals; and in each of these genera there are various degrees. For this reason Aristotle, *Metaph. viii (Did. vii, 3)*, compares the species of things to numbers, which differ in species by the addition or subtraction of unity. And (*De Anima ii, 3*) he compares the various souls to the species of figures, one of which contains another; as a pentagon contains and exceeds a tetragon. Thus the intellectual soul contains virtually whatever belongs to the sensitive soul of brute animals, and to the nutritive souls of plants. Therefore, as a surface which is of a pentagonal shape, is not tetragonal by one shape, and pentagonal by another—since a tetragonal shape would be superfluous as contained in the pentagonal—so neither is Socrates a man by one soul, and animal by another; but by one and the same soul he is both animal and man.*

The human soul is immaterial while the human body is material. The human soul has spiritual or rational faculties. These rational faculties are the intellect and will. Other corporeal living organisms do not have an intellect and will (*this can be shown through objective evidence*). The human soul, being immaterial, performs immaterial actions. Though the soul is immaterial, it depends or relies on what the body presents. My thinking and loving (which are carried out by my soul) are determined by what I experience in my body. I cannot think about something or love someone if I have never heard or experienced it through my senses. *Man is the only being that is born tabula rasa (a clean slate).* By nature I can think and love but my thinking and loving is fundamentally determined by the education and information I receive.

Man is the only being that is capable of appreciating beauty. Man is the only being capable of perceiving and understanding truth. Man is the only being that can know what is good, what is right or wrong. From these three issues it follows that man is a being that can appreciate aesthetics, knowledge (education) and ethics. Man realizes that beauty, truth and goodness are in a being and the being is a single individuated being (unity).

Furthermore, human life has an immaterial and incorruptible aspect, which means it can exist after the corruption of the body, i.e. death. *Death is defined as corruption by division after the soul separates from the body. The act which gives life separates from that which is given life. The rational soul is subsistent, though it is imperfect on its own.*

For a human person to be perfect he needs both a body and a soul. Since the soul of man can exist after death and cannot be corrupted by death (because it is immaterial and an act) then the life of man has a spiritual value. Behind the man-value there has to be, there is, a God-value or Spiritual value. The dignity of each man therefore resides in his psychosomatic nature, i.e. he has a body and rational soul. Each person has an equal dignity because each person has the same human nature.

The spirituality of the human soul altogether excludes the possibility of man arising through mere biological evolution. Even if the evolution of vegetative and sensitive life from inert matter were the result of purely natural forces (educing the forms from the potentiality of matter), this could not hold true for the origin of man since his spiritual soul cannot be educed from the potentiality of matter but can only arise by immediate creation [the principle of non-contradiction is key to resolving this]. Biologically, through genetics, it has been seen that man has come from some common biological parents [identity by descent, IBD]. The human soul does not come from the parents, since if the parents were the vivifying principle then they would not die. *Phrased in another way, if the parents of Alice are life, that is the life giving principle (per se) then they would not cease to exist and Alice would be totally dependent on his parents.* But nature shows us that parents die and their children still continue existing. Therefore the parents cannot be life but have life. This implies another source of life, outside the parents-the existence of the unmoved mover-a Creator of the form (soul). The human soul comes from a Creator who is the source of life and indeed is life. In the Creator, metaphysically, there is the identity of being and act of being. The parents provide the material aspects while the immaterial aspect comes from the Creator.

The soul informs the body at conception and not some months or weeks after conception. The evidence for this is that at conception, the being already starts demonstrating the four fundamental characteristics of life: growth and division; rhythm (fusion until birth); immanence for instance the baby has its own circulatory system; unity since the being is one and a different substance from the mother though dependent on her for nourishment. The embryo has specific potencies of a human being that are actualized sometime after birth, for instance thinking and loving.

Which conclusions can we develop from the fundamental characteristics of the human person?

Thomas Aquinas said: “A person means that which is most perfect in the order of nature” (S.Th. I, q. 29, a.3, a.4). Man is above corporeal things. The person is the most valuable being in comparison to the material universe. Man’s nature is above all material beings or things. The fundamental characteristics are *she/he is a spiritual being who has an immaterial form (spirituality); he can think (rationality); the thought process and other aspects of the soul are affected by the body and vice versa (somaticity); the person performs actions which are not tied to corporeality but can transcend the person’s existence for example thinking, loving and worshipping (transcendence).* Another aspect is that these spiritual, rational and somatic actions are at times externalized through rational language to other people (*Emergence*).

Mortality and immortality

It is in the face of death that the riddle of human existence grows most acute. Not only is man tormented by pain and by the advancing deterioration of his body, but even more so by a dread of perpetual extinction. All the endeavours of technology, though useful in the extreme, cannot

calm his anxiety; for prolongation of biological life is unable to satisfy that desire for higher life which is inescapably lodged in her/his breast. Religion gives an expression, connection and fulfilment to this longing.

Chapter 4

Are my passions and senses an obstacle or are they helpful?

Introduction

Apart from my senses (external and internal), I have other bodily aspects, for instance I feel, I am passionate about some things like movies, some things make me angry, sad or sorrowful. In addition, I have certain genetic traits called temperaments which make me who I am. Let us now examine each of these aspects and how they help the psychosomatic nature of the human person.

The connection between my senses and its corresponding tendencies

There is a close connection between my internal and external senses. Once my external senses have grasped their proper sensibles like light and sound, the common sense combines these proper sensibles to enable us to connect it with an object. When we see a bottle of Coca-cola, the feel of the bottle and the taste, we can infer that Coke has a particular taste and colour. The sense which combines the colour and taste is the common sense.

Once I see a bottle of Coke, I can feel attracted to it, especially if the taste and colour are desirable. I feel a pull-an attraction-a tendency towards it. This is called an appetite. The appetite relates to what I can feel and taste at the moment. It refers to the here and now appetite. It is a kind of desire.

I may also decide, well you see, this bottle of Coke is attractive but the money I have is sufficient only to pay for my transport. In this particular case, I may decide to forego the current pleasure for a future benefit, a future good. This means that there is a reference to the future. This appetite, or tendency towards the future good is very different from the present good. This appetite is not necessarily linked to the common sense but my memory and somehow also my survival instinct. It is a kind of impulse.

In the above example, we realize that there is an inter-relation between the senses and what we call appetites or tendencies. When we examine the appetites that arise due to the action of the senses, we realize there are two appetites: the pleasurable or present appetite; the appetite which refers to the difficult or future good.

The pleasurable appetite (desire) is referred to as the concupiscible appetite while the future appetite (impulse) is the irascible appetite.

Do the senses understand the being (thing) or the aspects of the being?

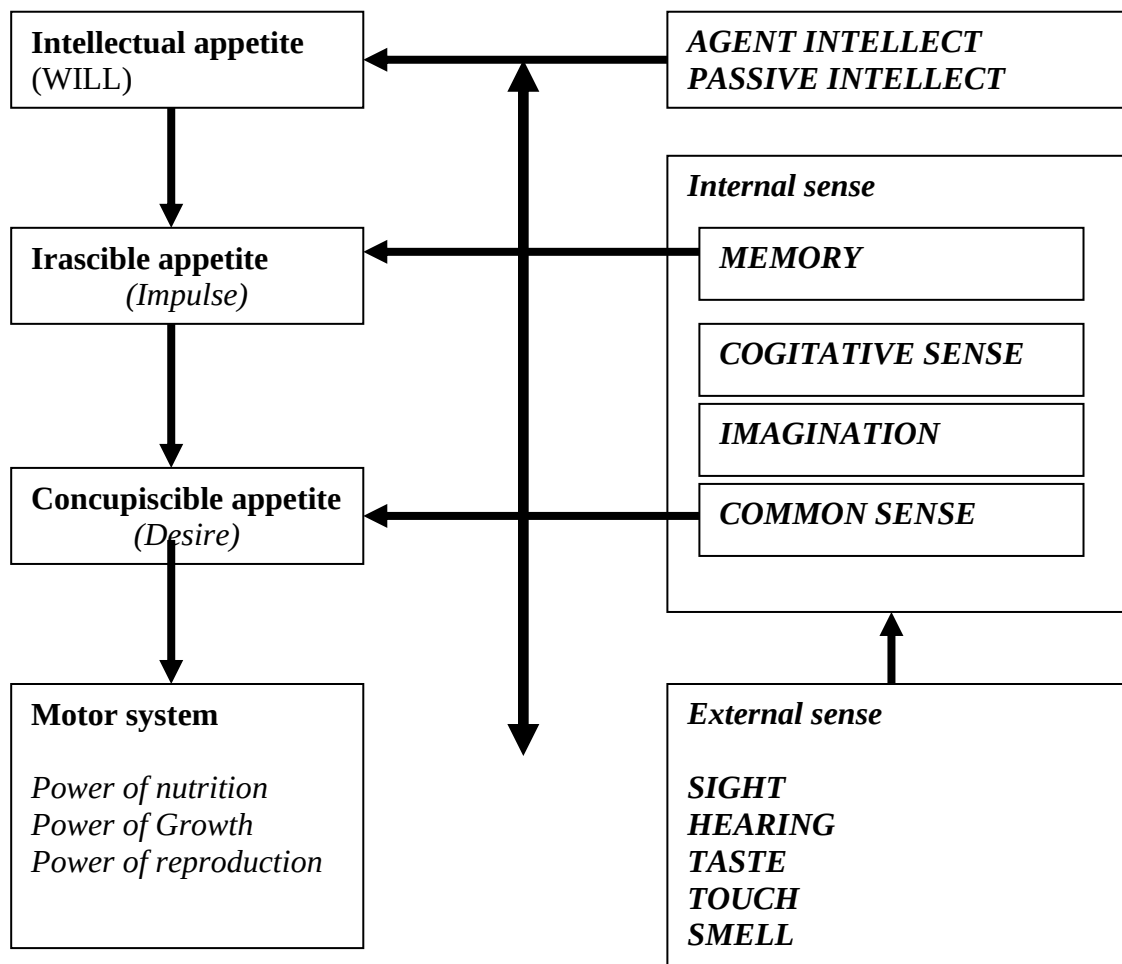
My senses grasp particular aspects of the being called accidents. My eyes grasp colour or texture which are qualities. The senses do not understand the thing but aspects of the thing. When my hands grasp the texture of the Coke bottle, my hand does not understand that it is Coke, rather its texture only. The more our senses experience something the clearer the perception. If I see something only once I may fail to notice the colour, the shape or size. The more I see it, the more I appreciate its colour, its shape, its size, texture and other accidents. This connects well with the English expression, *out of sight- out of mind*. We remember things which we keep experiencing. We know well things which we keep experiencing. We love the things which we keep experiencing.

What we experience through the senses is conditioned by nervous processes in the brain and in the organs of sense (Mimbi, 2007, p. 74). If there is a problem with the nervous system, we may fail to perceive something accurately; for instance, when someone is paralyzed he may not be able to feel some things.

In addition, what we have in our memory and imagination are conditioned by brain connections. If my brain is alert, I will perceive more things and will be able to memorize easily. If my brain is drowsy due to let's say an intake of alcohol, I will not be able to perceive some things and I may fail to memorize a number of issues.

The final point in this section is to remember that my intellect works on what my senses perceive. The people who appear to be very intelligent perceive many issues and consequently have deeper abstraction. We shall examine this issue in greater depth under the topic of the human intellect.

A summarized diagram of the sense and sense appetites Mimbi (2007)



The left side of the diagram presents the different powers and appetites. The right side presents the different senses and the intellect. The discussion in this topic stops at the third level, the irascible appetite. We shall examine the agent and passive intellect in the topic *Human Intellect* and the Intellectual appetite in the topic *Human will*.

The direction of the arrows on the right-hand side shows how the senses act sequentially, i.e. from external senses to internal senses. The intellect works on the products in the memory. The human intellect informs the human will.

The direction of the arrows on the left-hand side shows the order in terms of control. The human will control the irascible and concupiscible appetite.

As a human being do I have human affectivity?

Human affectivity refers to those bodily aspects or bodily reactions that are neither appetites nor actions of the senses. These include *sentiments; emotions; affections; passions; feelings of pleasure or pain; sorrow*.

Sentiments are neither just a general state of the mind with regard to something nor a strong subjective response. It is a way of feeling that is both sensitive and also affects the mind (mental) for example sadness.

Emotions are strong feelings which cause an intense mental disturbance. An example of an emotion is anger. Anger the most often expressed human emotion, expressed several times a day by any individual can be the consequence of many internal and external factors including biological, psychological, behavioural, and social. All these have to be defined in family, peer, media, and social contexts. Internal factors include the type of personality, lack of problem-solving skills, unpleasant memories, effects of hormones, anxiety, depression, hostility, tension, agitation, problems of the nervous system, etc. The presence of a prior negative affect state may intensify anger and lower the ability to control self. External factors include negative parental practices, situational and environmental factors (traffic jams, barking dogs, horn honking, loud noise, etc.), effect of peers and media, socio-economic status, social stress, etc. In today's fast growing, competitive, and technologically advanced life, positive emotions have lost their meanings. Terrorist activities around the world have threatened humanity and made everyone feel insecure all the time. Many negative emotions especially insecurity and fear can be transformed into the emotion of Anger (Bhave & Saini, 2009, pp. 3-4).

Affections are an emotional state in regard to persons for instance when one meets a friend or a relative. Affections can be expressed through handshakes or a hug.

Passions are strong feelings which are at times accompanied by a sensuous element. For instance, when a diehard fanatic of the World Cup watches a soccer match he may easily forget about other important things.

Pleasure is a kind of feeling that occurs when there is harmony between perception and the function. There is a harmony between perceived good with sensitive good for instance eating a specific kind of food. Pain on the other hand occurs when there is lack of harmony between perceived good and sensitive good for instance taking a bitter herb.

Sorrow is caused by a present evil. It is repugnant to the will and represses it from enjoying that which it wishes to enjoy.

Human temperaments

“Know thyself, and thy faults, and thus live.” Augustine of Hippo

The role of human temperaments has been emphasized in a number of books. Keirsey, in his book, *Please understand me*, uses the temperaments to classify the different variety of personalities. Veronica Roth, in her book, *The Divergent* presents a dystopian world which is classified according to the four temperaments. Let us now examine what are human temperaments and their role:

Temperaments are a native personality, and that alone, that endows a man to stand before presidents or generals, or in any distinguished collection, with aplomb — and not culture, or any knowledge or intellect whatever.” Walt Whitman.

Temperaments are also hereditary traits-in born. They are neither good nor bad because we do not choose them. We find ourselves with specific temperaments.

The tradition that gave us the four “classical” temperaments goes back thousands of years (Bennett, 2005).

Hippocrates (c. 460-377 B.C.), the “father of medical science,” may have been the first to develop a personality theory. He claimed that human bodies contained four main types of fluid, and that each individual could be categorized as one of four temperaments based on an imbalance of those fluids in his body — hence, the rather unappealing names:

- *Choleric: yellow bile from the liver.*
- *Sanguine: blood from the heart.*
- *Melancholic: black bile from the kidneys.*
- *Phlegmatic: phlegm from the lungs.*

Around 190 A.D., the Roman physician Galen, following Hippocrates, proposed that the balance of our bodily fluids (the “humors”) indeed affects our temperament, but positively, rather than as the result of a negative imbalance. Thus, the “sanguine” temperament was eager and optimistic; the “melancholic” was doleful; “choleric” passionate, and the “phlegmatic” calm.

In The Republic, Plato wrote about four kinds of character and their contribution to the social order. Clinical psychologist David Keirsey relates Plato’s characters to the original four types of temperament: the iconic was “artistic,” or sanguine; the pistic was the “guardian” or “caretaker” and was melancholic; the noetic was an “idealist” and was choleric; and the dianoetic character was “rational,” a “logical investigator,” or phlegmatic.

In the sixteenth century, a Swiss physician and alchemist named Paracelsus compared the four temperament types to the four elements of fire, air, water, and earth. He added the concept of the “fifth element,” or “quintessence,” which was the mysterious connection and balance among the four elements.

Although the concept of the four types had been around since the early Greeks, the use of the word temperament first came into use in the seventeenth century. The Latin word

temperamentum, or “mixture,” was used to refer to the necessary balance that was sought in order to achieve health and well-being.

In 1920, Swiss psychologist Carl Jung advanced the theory that different personality types approached the outside world in distinct manners and could be clearly categorized accordingly.

Isabel Briggs Myers (1897-1979) spent forty years refining the Jungian typology into the Myers’ Briggs Type Indicator, with its sixteen types of personality. The Myers-Briggs Type Indicator, or MBTI, is considered to be one of the most widely used personality inventories available and has achieved great popular success. Yet David Keirsey, in his Keirsey Temperament Sorter, has ascertained (after extensive research into both Jungian typology and the MBTI) that the sixteen types really boil down to — surprise! — four basic temperaments.

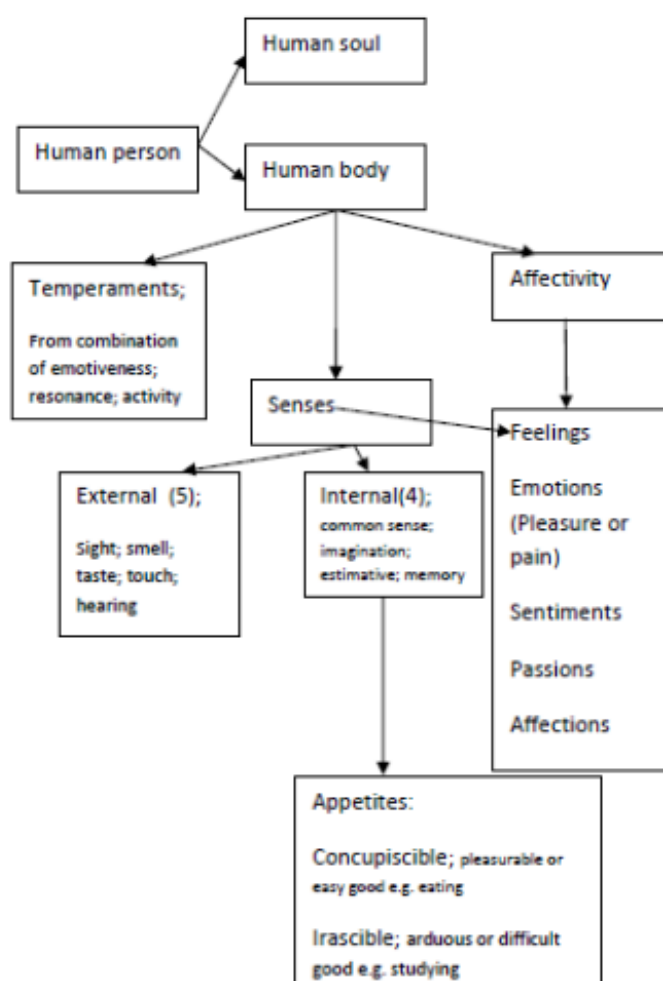
Each of us is uniquely and predominantly one of the temperaments: choleric, phlegmatic, melancholic, or sanguine. Today, people all over the world are re-discovering the value and wisdom of this most ancient tool for understanding themselves and others. To get more information on the temperaments refer to Mimbi P, Overlooked Factor (2007, p.270).

It is important to note that temperaments do not necessarily determine our character. Our characters are a combination of the genetic traits (temperaments) and the choices we make (habits). If a person who is passionate so decides, he can cultivate the character of being calm when faced with tense situations.

Conclusion

If temperament is the type of soil and character, the crops that are grown on it, a habit is the combination of both. Habits are acquired qualities that determine the activity of the faculties in one way or another. They are intrinsic principles of operation, and their effect redounds on the individual who possesses them. They have a cumulative effect on the personality of an individual. This is the same as saying that the personality of an individual is given by the sum total of his habits (Mimbi, 2007, p.274).

The appetites have their corresponding habits. The subject Principle of Ethics will give an in-depth analysis of the right balance in each of these habits: the habit of the concupiscible appetite-*temperance*; the habit of the irascible appetite-*fortitude*; the habit of the intellect-*prudence*; the habit of the intellectual appetite/will- *justice*.



Concept map of the human body

Chapter 5

A happy life follows thinking.

Introduction

The famous Albert Einstein was once quoted saying “*The world as we have created it is a process of our thinking. It cannot be changed without changing our thinking*”. Man is *homo sapiens- thinking man*. Man makes himself through his thought process and he can even fail because of this. *A non-examined life is not worth living*. Many people engage in the common rat race of each and every day without pausing to reflect. The world of technology and the Internet does not make it easier. Technology places information at our fingertips more easily than before. *People listen to radio shows without asking questions. People watch television without asking questions. People listen to politicians without asking questions. People read newspapers without asking questions. In these situations, they become mere zombies left to the designs and wishes of radio presenters, politicians or authors*. What differentiates man from other species is that she/he thinks. We cannot take this for granted. Even though man is called *homo sapiens*, it does not follow that he will always think. The mind needs to be trained in the art and science of thinking. If man does not think before acting, there is no difference between him/her and another animal that does not think. *We need to think, analyze and develop real solutions in life*.

Definition

Aristotle in De Anima (ii, 3) defines the intellectual faculty as the power of the soul. The object of the intellect is truth. The intellect is the power to abstract.

The power of one- the power of abstraction

There is a fundamental difference between man and another sentient being. Man is a being with intelligence. Intelligence is the power to read into the nature of a thing. *When man looks at an object like a pen, he does not only see the object itself, i.e. the colour, texture or size. Man understands that the object he sees in front of him falls into the general class of pen. Pen is therefore a concept which the mind has abstracted. The concept, pen, is immaterial. The concept is bereft of matter. When I mention pen or man, the mind does not think of a particular material pen or man, and yet it understands the meaning, the nature of the concept.*

The intellect in the aforementioned example has formed a concept. The formation of the concept is abstraction. *A chimpanzee cannot form a concept though it sees the image*. Abstraction, as shall be explained later, is the first step in the thought process. Human language is an exteriorization of the mental concept. The term Pen is a verbal/written expression in English. The same concept can be expressed differently in another language. We can therefore conclude that human language finds meaning in the mental words-the concepts. Concepts are a representation of reality. Human language is meaningful to the extent that it represents reality.

Isn't the brain the mind (intellect)?

In some situations, people use these terms inter-changeably: brain and mind. The two terms are quite distinct. The brain represents the somatic element or material aspect, while the mind (intellect) represents the immaterial aspect. The brain works hand in hand with the mind. This is what psychologists refer to as the brain and mind complex.

The brain is a biological machine, pre-programmed at conception in the genetic code. It serves as a control centre for all physical, cognitive, emotional activities, and spontaneous processes in the body. Within the brain, chemicals are programmed within the genetic code to be secreted in specific amounts at specific times throughout the individual's lifetime. These chemicals act dependently or independently, initiating various reactions (signal transduction pathways for example). The mind goes beyond the brain's basic chemical functioning. The mind is dependent upon it only in so far as it is the organ par excellence of internal sensation.

Can the brain work without the mind?

As we have just mentioned, the mind is dependent on the brain in so far as it is the organ par excellence of the internal sensation. The common sense and the memory (*internal senses*) occupy specific internal organs in the brain. Before the mind begins the process of abstraction it depends on the images stored in the memory. But once abstraction has begun, the thought process can continue without the brain. A person who has had brain injury does not necessarily lose the power to analyze or judge issues. The memory may be affected, and as such she/he may forget what he is experiencing, nevertheless the mind can still judge events and form conclusions.

What is the thought process?

Introduction to the thought process

Thought begins as an operation (an act) and remains and grows as a habit. Jane when she is young begins to think (an operation). She frequently thinks about playing the violin and what it entails playing it. As she grows, her parents realize she has this interest and therefore introduces her to a tutor who can train her in the art of playing the violin. With time, whenever she is free, she thinks more and more about the violin and the different keys she can play. What began first as a mere thought ends up becoming a habit. She ends up becoming a true violinist. This means that each act of her understanding creates more capacity to abstract, to reason about playing the violin. The pattern of (intellectual) behaviour acquired through frequent repetition of the operations of the mind is called an intellectual habit. This is equivalent to saying that thought as an act is transient; it is a passing event. In order to know more, one has to elicit a new thought act. The thought process takes place basically in three levels: abstraction, judgment and reasoning (Mimbi, 2007, p.139).

There are three steps in the thought process: i) abstraction; ii) judgment; iii) forming conclusions or reasons.

Abstraction

Abstraction depends on the memory and the other senses. Abstraction is the process where the mind forms a concept or idea. An example of abstraction is when I say I have ten fingers. The number ten is an abstraction, a representation of reality. In actual sense, we do not see the number ten in reality but we count ten objects. We can infer that 10 is a representation of reality. The concept signifies what is understood in the mind insofar as it is in the mind. *Concepts only exist in the mind*. The danger is to think that since my mind can abstract reality, it is my mind that creates reality. *Rene Descartes (Cartesian thought) had a similar idea when he mentioned, I think therefore I am (cogito ergo sum). He thought it is because I think that I exist. He*

inverted the order in reality. The order is first a person exists (I am) then he thinks. One's existence does not depend on thought. A child is a child, and continues to exist whether or not he thinks. The statement should be rephrased to *I am therefore I think*.

Many modern Philosophers have borrowed heavily from the Cartesian thought process and presume that reality depends on one's thinking.

Concepts can be applied in three ways: i) *universally* which refers to all beings which have a similar nature for instance men refers to all beings with the human nature; ii) *particularly* to beings which share some features and these features are not due to nature for instance, these are students of Strathmore University; iii) *singularly* to a being's uniqueness for instance Jennifer's thinking and loving only belongs to Jennifer since these are personal actions. These actions are different from Alexia's thinking and loving.

Judgment

Once the mind abstracts, the next step is to form a judgment. Judgment is when the mind predicates or attributes something to a concept, for instance when I say that Subaru is blue. The blue colour is connected (attributed) to a Subaru.

Judgment is formed when I use the affirmation or negation of the word *to be*, either in the future (*will be*), past (*was*), present tense (*is*) and in whichever case, first person, second person or third person.

Judgments have subjects and predicates. *In the statement Kenyans are runners, the subject is Kenyans, and the predicate is runners.*

Conclusion (reasoning)

In forming a conclusion, we are comparing a number of arguments in order to arrive at a consistent and valid statement. These arguments are judgments. This issue was presented in the previous subject, critical thinking, where the emphasis was to examine syllogisms and determine whether they were consistent and valid. Consistent syllogisms are those which have clear premises which lead to clear conclusions. There are no chances of misrepresentations. Validity in a syllogism answers the question whether a premise and consequently the conclusion has any basis in reality. If the conclusion does not have any basis in reality and has been construed in an erroneous way we call it a *fallacy*.

An example of a simple syllogism with clear premises and a conclusion is:

- i) Peter is a man (Premise 1)
- ii) All men are animals (Premise 2)

Conclusion Peter is an animal.

In the above example, the conclusion is derived from the premises and hence is consistent. It is also valid because the statements Peter is a man and all men are animals are true in reality.

An example of a fallacy or an invalid argument is:

- i) Peter is a Kenyan
- ii) Some Kenyans are good runners

Conclusion: Peter is a good runner (*invalid*).

The conclusion is erroneous since may be Peter may not be a Kenyan, and he may also not be a good runner. An error of generalization may arise.

In the above example, we realize that the process of thinking relates to three types of knowledge:

- a) *Knowledge of the senses*: This is where the external or internal senses possess their proper sensibles, for instance images in the imagination or colour in the eye.
- b) *Conceptual knowledge*: Conceptual knowledge refers to the mind forming an abstraction from the images, i.e. a concept.
- c) *Reflexive knowledge*: Reflexive knowledge is where the mind forms judgments and compares the judgments with reality. *Is Peter a runner? Is he a Kenyan?*

At the end of the thinking process truth is formed. The *main aim of thinking is to know truth*.

What is truth (Quid est Veritas?)

Truth is the conformance of the mind with reality-the beginning point of the reflexive process is reality. Truth expresses reality faithfully (Alvira, Clavell, & Melendo, 1982, p. 151). In the definition of truth, there is truth in the mind (logical truth) and reality (ontological truth).

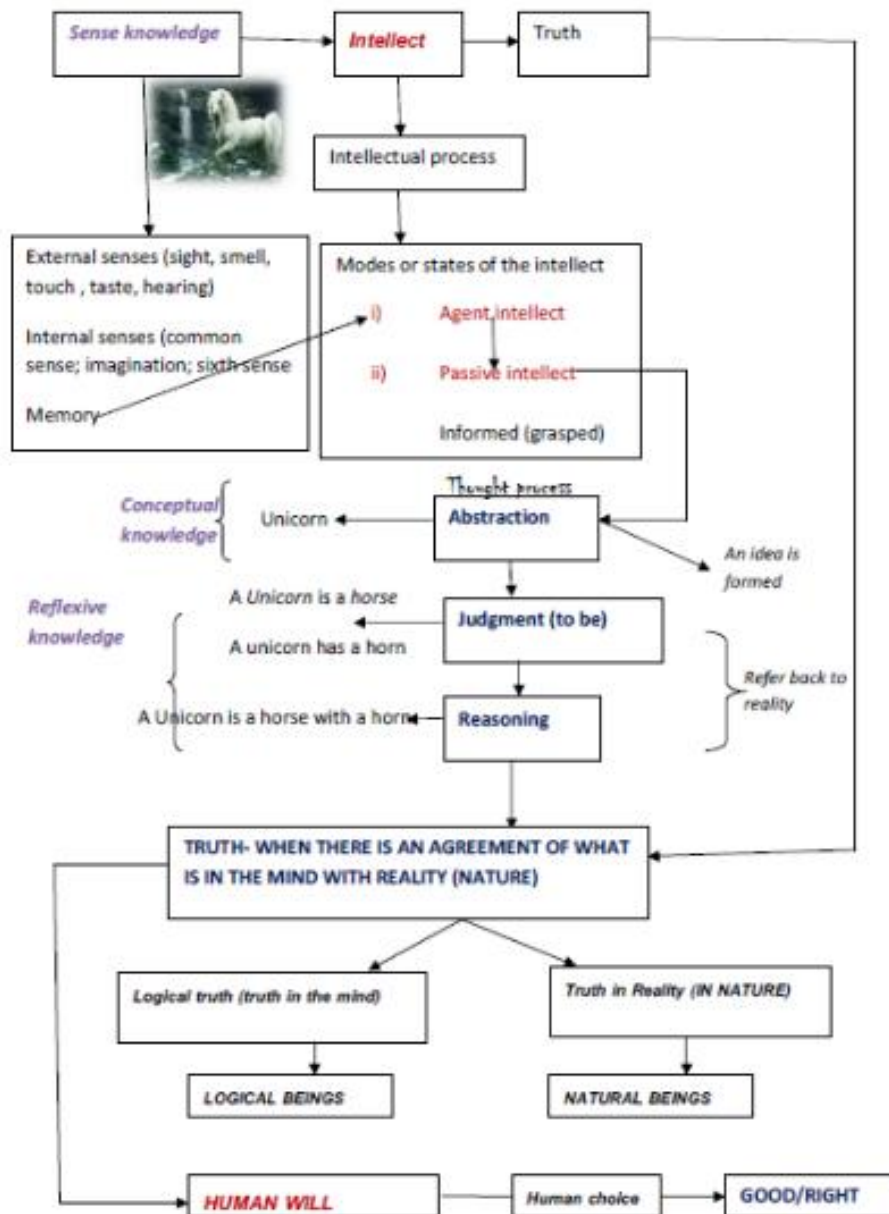
Logical truth (rational truth)

The conformity of the intellect to things, conforming itself to that which they are, is logical truth or truth of the mind, for which we say that the mind is true. If in my mind, I form a conclusion that Kenya is in West Africa, the truth in my mind does not agree with reality and thus there is a logical error. If I say that Kenya is in East Africa, I will say it is true. The logical truth in my mind agrees with reality.

Ontological truth

Ontological truth is the conformity of some beings to some intelligence. It is important to state that this type of truth does not depend on the fact that they be known. It should conform to the mind of the creator. The truth of the beauty of the Mona Lisa is fully known by its painter-its creator. Thus the painting, ontologically, needs to conform to the mind of the originator. Ontological truth is truth outside the subject, i.e. objective truth.

Concept map of the human intellect and its relation with my will



The intellect's transcendence and immateriality

The intellect is and of itself immaterial and consequently its object. When something is immaterial, it means it is incorruptible. This means that the intellect is transcendent. It can continue existing after death. The objective reasons for the intellect's immateriality and transcendence are:

- i) The actions which my mind performs are not material. The process of abstraction, judgment and reasoning are not physical actions. The concept is devoid of material aspects, and consequently the arguments which are formed are not material but purely logical.
- ii) The thinking process is limitless. Since the concepts formed are immaterial. One cannot reach the end of thinking, neither can one say he knows enough and the mind is full of concepts. The mind is not a material organ.
- iii) The mind understands the intelligible aspects of being, the nature of beings. The intelligible aspects are immaterial. My mind understands the truth of being.
- iv) Apart from its limitless nature, the development of the mind is continuous and does not have any limit. Physical growth does have a limit and is constrained by the physical aspects. This is not the case for the human mind.
- v) The mind, as a rational faculty, can deny things that it perceives. The capacity of the intellect for denying things also proves its non-materiality. The intelligence not only affirms, it also denies. *I may adamantly refuse that Alfred has never been to Strathmore while in reality he has been there. No material organ can do this. Even if the eye does not want it, once it is open and it is not defective it perceives colour.* The eye cannot deny colour; the ear cannot deny sound; yet the mind can deny that what it perceives as not true. This capacity for the mind turning for reflection proves that it is immaterial. The mind can go out to the object in reality and back to the mind without it being corrupted.

The intellect performs two interesting actions: the mind moves to the collection of images in the memory and afterwards abstracts and reflects on what it has in the mind. Before the mind has begun the process of abstraction, we realize that the mind is in potency-it is passive. The mind at the same time moves out-there is an action of- grasping the intelligible aspects from what is stored in memory.

The agent intellect is the state where the mind moves to the recollections in the memory (internal sense) in order to abstract the intelligible species.

The passive intellect is informed by the agent intellect. It seizes being passive when it is informed, when it has the concept and consequently begins forming judgments and reflections.

Is there any relation between Intelligence Quotient (IQ) and Emotional Intelligence (EQ)?

Intelligence quotient refers to the capacity of an individual to abstract and read into the nature of things, including his ability to analyze ideas. It is very different from Emotion Intelligence.

The concept of emotional intelligence was presented by Daniel Goleman in his book *Emotional Intelligence*. In it, he explains emotional intelligence as the competence to identify and express emotions, understand emotions, assimilate emotions in thought, and regulate both positive and negative emotions in the self and others (Mathews, Zeidner & Roberts, 2002, p. 3).

A person with emotional intelligence is able not only to think in the right way, but is able to understand others (empathetic), can feel what they feel, can reason with others and can use this in making decisions which are mutually beneficial to all. Emotional intelligence goes beyond the normal concept of IQ (intelligence quotient) because it looks not only at the capacity to reason, but also to network with others.

Successful businessmen and entrepreneurs have high EQ. They may not have a high IQ. EI has been commonly claimed to play an important role in modern society by determining real-life outcomes above and beyond the contribution of the general intellectual ability and personality factors. Thus, EI is claimed to be positively related to academic achievement, occupational success and satisfaction, emotional health and adjustment. EI, in fact, has been claimed by Goleman (1995) to be more important than intellectual intelligence in achieving success in life.

Emotional intelligence entails four aspects: i) identification of emotions; ii) reflection on these emotions and how they impact thinking and relating with others; iii) monitoring emotions; iv) management of emotions through appraisal and expression of emotions in the right way.

Conclusion

The current trends tend to relativize truth. Some people think that truth is purely subjective and it depends on a person's upbringing. The reality is that if truth is not objective, then we cannot talk about science and real knowledge. Truth has to be based on objective evidence.

People who tend to relativize truth can say that truth is an individual matter (liberalism), truth depends on what society defines truth to be (social constructivism), truth depends on the structures (structuralism) or truth comes from within and the categories I have (immanentism).

When the subjective approach to truth is applied to morals it results to moral relativism with its consequent variants like liberalism (you are free to do anything as long as it does not interfere with another person's freedom), utilitarianism which states that what is moral depends on what gives the greatest happiness to the greatest number (maximizes utility) or even that it depends on rationally showing that something is moral or not (rationalism).

Man cannot live without truth, for truth is the object of the intellect. In anthropology, the important theme is the relation of man with the truth and man's personal encounter with it. The real point is that without discovering the truth- one is ignorant, though he may not be guilty of such ignorance. And before truth there are only two attitudes: acceptance or rejection, serving it or make it serve, submit to it or submit it to one's interests.

Chapter 6

I am happy!

Each person wants to be happy. If you ask someone what really is happiness, you may get as many answers as there are persons. Some people equate happiness with the subjective feeling of pleasure, i.e. I am happy when I enjoy or get maximum pleasure. Some people say I am happy when I am loved by someone. Another common answer is that happiness is when I have positive emotions. Others say happiness is the experience of joy, contentment, or positive well-being, combined with a sense that one's life is good, meaningful, and worthwhile(Lyubomirsky 2007).

But what really is happiness? Does it have an objective element or is it purely subjective? Does each person want to be happy?

Philosophers have investigated happiness more thoroughly than anyone. They've boiled the debate over happiness down to a battle between two basic views, hedonia and eudaimonia. The former, hedonia, is arguably the more famous (or notorious) of the two, though both find their roots in classical Greek philosophy (Clark, 2014).

The hedonistic view (hedonia) of well-being is that happiness is the polar opposite of suffering; the presence of happiness indicates the absence of pain. Because of this, hedonists believe that the purpose of life is to maximize happiness, which minimizes misery. Over the years, hedonism has developed something of a bad image, as its focus is on propagating pleasure through any means available, including sexuality, excessive consumption, alcohol, drugs and other targets of religious and societal scorn (Clark, 2014).

On the other side of the debate is eudaimonia, a term that combines the Greek words for "good" and "spirit" to describe it. Eudaimonia defines happiness as the pursuit of becoming a better person. Eudaemonists do this by challenging themselves intellectually or by engaging in activities that make them spiritually richer people (Clark, 2014).

I want to be happy!

Each person, without exception wants to be happy. Maybe people can disagree about the means to be happy. But generally, each human being acts because she/he wants to be happy. This means that for each person there is a common denominator, that of happiness. Happiness is perceived by the human person as the ultimate good.

The next question is what is the connection between my happiness and the understanding of truth presented in the previous chapter? To connect the two concepts, happiness and truth

What appetite in man is responsible for choosing the good?

*The appetite in man which is responsible for **choosing the good is the rational appetite or the will. The will is the faculty that inclines us to make choices.***

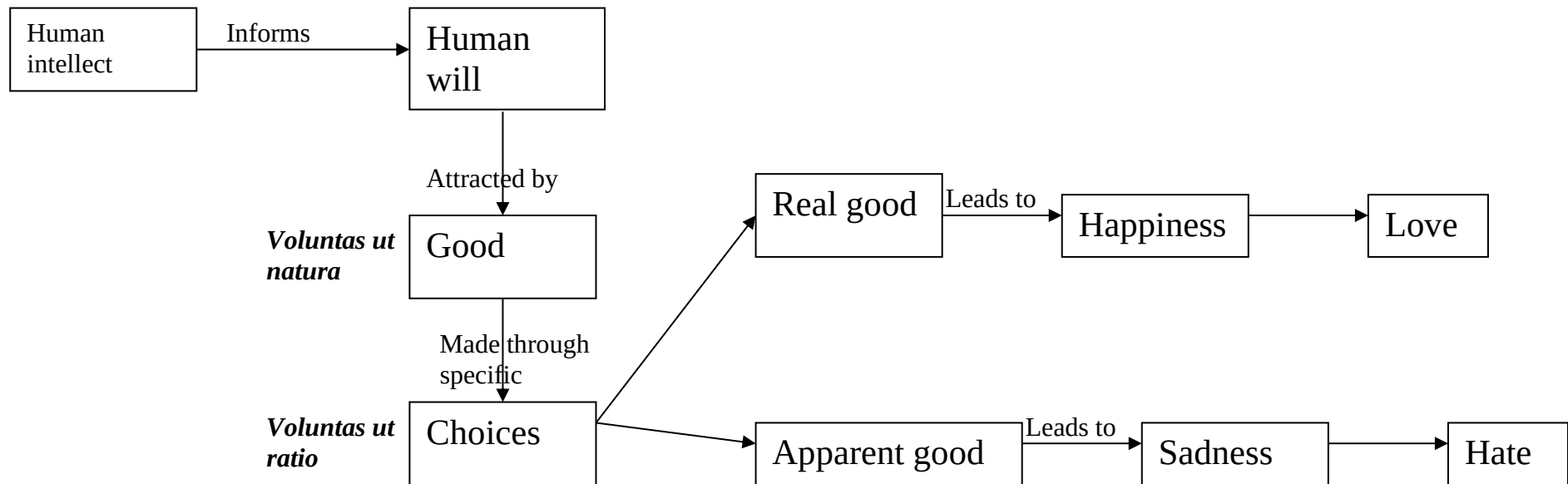
The object of the will is the good. If the good attained is the real good, the person becomes happy.

The action of the will follows that of the intellect. It is impossible for someone to choose something he does not know. To act correctly, one needs to know the correct way. We can therefore form a close connection between the senses and the will. The senses perceive the proper sensibles. The agent intellect picks the intelligible aspects from the images in memory (internal sense) and acts on it. At the end of the thought process man is able to discover the

truth. The intellect, which has grasped the truth, moves the will to make choices. The choices are known by the intellect.

Though the will is last in terms of execution, it may decide to follow or not to follow the intellect. The will can thus perform two actions, according to choice or nature. By nature the will chooses something because it is good (good by nature- ***voluntas ut natura***). The choice is not pre-determined, I can choose to act in one way or another, hence the will acts according to choice (action by choice- ***voluntas ut ratio***).

The following diagram summarizes the action of the will.



The intellect must first know the truth which is abstract and simple. The object of the intellect in this sense is higher since it moves the will. The simpler and the more abstract a thing is, the nobler and higher it is in itself.

The object of the will is not this or that good, but the good in its most universal connotation. Aristotle noted this in his *Rhetoric*, by saying that we hate all kinds of thieves, not any given thief in particular. If the will refers to universals, it must be spiritual, for no universal is material (Juan-Selles, 2010, p. 113).

Man is the only being that can make choices, because as we explained earlier she/he is the only intelligent being. *The object of the intellect and will are not material but immaterial. When we say this laptop is good; goodness does not refer only to this laptop. We may also say the tree you see there is good. Diana is good... Good is therefore universal and not particular (specific).* Good is not material. We can therefore deduce that the will is not material. But are these the only arguments which show the immateriality of the human will? No. Which other arguments are there which show that the human will is immaterial?

Is my will immaterial (spiritual)?

The will can choose the material and immaterial, it is not confined to specific things. I can choose this laptop. I can choose to worship in a particular way. I can choose to love a particular person. In this sense good is not confined to material objects.

The actions of the will do not have a limit. We can make infinite choices for the good. I can choose to listen to music at the same time read a book. I can keep on choosing or making choices without feeling tired or exhausting my will. Since my will does not have a limit, we can say that it is immaterial since material organs have a limit while that which is immaterial has no limit. Also when we say we love someone, love is an immaterial aspect. Even though that individual may not be there physically we still continue loving her/him. We cannot say that we have reached the end of love. Love does not have a limit.

*The ultimate end of the will, i.e. happiness, is an immaterial aspect. When we say I am happy, we have to differentiate two things, the pleasure I have at the moment from the state of fulfilment. **Happiness is not the same as pleasure.** A person can feel pleasure doing something but afterwards feel totally empty. On the other hand, a person may sacrifice himself to do a job and afterwards, though she may be tired feel self fulfilled-happy. Since the end of the will is immaterial, it must be in and of itself immaterial.*

The will can make a choice for the apparent good, even deny itself but does not disappear afterwards. No material organ can deny itself. If it does, then it stops to exist. For instance, if I decide not to eat or put anything in the stomach, I will soon cease to exist. This does not happen in the case of the will. The will can refuse to make certain choices but does not disappear after that.

Therefore the will is by its nature immaterial or spiritual.

Is the statement “I love” different from “I like”?

Only human beings can love. Love is very different from liking. A dog can like its master but not love its master. As explained, love, an act of the will follows knowledge. Since dogs cannot form concepts it implies, they cannot reason and consequently they cannot love. A human being can like and love. *A person can say, though I do not like my job or this person, meaning I am not physically attracted to the job or person, I still love my job or person.* This is not a contradiction but a clear manifestation of the complex nature of man. An animal cannot form this distinction.

How do I make choices?

After examining the nature and object of the will, the next issue is to provide an explanation of how a person makes choices. How do I make choices?

Assume I am a student who wants to watch a soccer match. The two teams are Brazil and Germany. The following day I have a Fundamentals of Accounting exam and I need to study. How do I decide to make the right choice?

- i) I need to clearly know that I have to make two choices, either watch the interesting soccer match or study for my exam. The mind knows the concepts: soccer match and study.
- ii) The will at this moment has not made any specific choice. Since I support Germany, I really want to watch the match. At the same time I realize I have not read enough. The will is therefore attracted to both. *This is simple volition.*
- iii) The mind (intellect) then starts deliberating. If I watch the soccer match I may not pass the exam. I can also record the soccer match. If I study I may pass the exam. *This is some form of cost-benefit analysis- deliberation.*
- iv) The will desires these different ends or judgments which the mind performs- *consilium.*
- v) The intellect then makes a conclusion. I will study and record the soccer match. This is the final step in the reasoning process.
- vi) The will then grasps the idea of reading as good. I want to read. The choice has been made (*Elicited actions*).
- vii) The will then commands the body to perform specific movements: record the soccer match; pick specific text books and to read. This are commanded actions- *Execution (commanded actions).*
- viii) The will perseveres in the good. After reading and doing the exam, I realize that I have scored highly in my Fundamentals of Accounting exam. I am happy. *This is the stage of fruition or the will has attained its end.*
- ix) *The mind is also at repose (relaxed) because I realize I made the right choice.*

In the above example, we note two examples of the will when making a choice. It can elicit specific choices and then also command. These two actions are elicited acts and commanded acts.

Chapter 7

I want my freedom!

I am free. I can do anything I want. I can make any choice. There is a tendency in today's world to insist on freedom and to forget that freedom is eternally married to responsibility. The person who is free is responsible for his/her actions. *The other slogan, quite common nowadays is my freedom stops where the other person's freedom begins. But is this true? Is freedom bound or limited by another person's freedom?*

Freedom and choice

Aristotle was once quoted saying, *"he who has overcome fears is truly free."* Overcoming fears is connected with the recognition of one's limitations and the realization that we become through and with others. A society should provide conditions where freedoms can be exercised. When I say I am free, I recognize that I am; I exist as an independent being. The freedom I have proceeds from my nature. True freedom acts in accord with nature. *If I say, I am free to jump up and gravity should not bring me down, I will realize that the freedom I am demanding is crazy or unnatural.* We need to realize that true freedom is connected to my rational nature. *I need to direct my freedom through right reason. Freedom in this sense is directed.*

Freedom is not for the sake of freedom but for some other end. What is the end of freedom? I am free to exercise my freedom through specific choices but these choices should realize my nature. We mentioned in the first chapter that man is a psychosomatic being, a unity of body and soul. This means that freedom should help me fulfil my psychosomatic nature. Since freedom is directed through right reason, freedom has some specific order.

Definition of freedom

Freedom is the capacity of choosing the good.

Various types of freedom

Amartya Sen in his book *Development as Freedom* presents different variants of freedom: *constitutive freedom and instrumental freedom.* Classical Philosophers have identified other kinds of freedom: *freedom as virtue; social freedom.*

Constitutive freedom

This refers to the right of free agency. A person should be free to live out the kind of life she/he desires to live. In his nature, man should be able to know and make choices. Man should be able to choose the good freely. There is need to educate the mind and conscience of man so that she/he can make rational choices. *Each man in his nature has freedom of conscience, freedom of association, freedom of religion and speech and has a right to education. A person should be able to act freely within the society.*

Instrumental freedom

In Sen's view, instrumental freedom constitutes: political freedom (the right to exercise political choices), economic facilities (creating enabling decisions to make economic choices), social

opportunities, transparency and security. *Instrumental freedom is therefore conceived as a means towards the attainment of specific ends- the overall well-being of man.*

Freedom as choice

Whenever a person mentions freedom, she/he usually refers to freedom as choice. *Freedom as choice means that man has free will to pick amongst alternatives. This in the previous section is referred to as **voluntas ut ratio**. Though man can choose amongst many alternatives, we realize that some alternatives make him happy while others make him sad. What makes a person happy or sad depends on whether whatever choices he makes accord or is not in accord with his nature. Let us give an example, assume I decide that killing is fine. I am free to do anything. In this case I decide I am free to kill. We realize that this choice first is not rational because it is not in accord with one's nature and cannot make a person happy. Man by nature is zoon politikon (a political animal); he lives with others and perfects his nature through others. Therefore the destruction of the nature of others is also a destruction of his own nature. The freedom that I have is not absolute. The limit is my nature. The choices are limited by my nature. If I choose against human nature I destroy myself.*

There are a number of errors which arise in terms of freedom of choice, let us examine just two cases: i) some people think that their choices have been pre-determined by an absolute being- God. In this particular case, they find consolation in saying *God knew I would make this choice, therefore why should I worry. Another form of escapism is to say God knows where I will end up, so why worry about the choices I will make.* They forget that in this particular instance fore-knowledge does not imply causality. The fact that someone may know the choices I will make (fore-knowledge) does not mean he is the one responsible for such choices (causality); ii) some people tend towards liberalism, which states that I am free to do anything as long as I don't hurt others. In this instance they may give valid reasons for doing bodily harm to themselves. This is a wrong understanding of freedom of choice because my freedom has to perfect my nature. The moment I hurt my nature then that freedom is not perfective but defective.

Freedom as virtue

I will just give an overview of this aspect of freedom since the subject Principles of Ethics will cover the subject: what is virtue and how to acquire it. Freedom as virtue consists in a person making the right choices repeatedly. *The choices are for the real good and not apparent good. The choices that a person makes for the real good are not done just once but are done repeatedly. Hence virtue is a good action done repeatedly and directed by right reason.*

Social freedom

When a person acts in the right way, his actions do not take place in a vacuum. Hence a virtuous action is not only an individual action but has a social dimension. When I choose to be just and practice justice in society, this action takes a social dimension. In this case it can become a form of commutative justice (between members in a community). If it is exercised by the rulers to the citizens it becomes distributive justice. A society with social freedom fights: ignorance; poverty; disease; political oppression. In such a society there is a balance between the common good and the individual good. *Social freedom is where a society provides all the means necessary for a person to be an active member.*

Social freedom brings with it another fundamental aspect, the right to association. Man should be able to associate freely. Through the right to association, man is able to exercise his affection (love) in different ways.

Love as a radical act of the will

Unlike the sensitive appetites, the will has an infinite capacity to love. Love is to make a gift of self to another.

Love is termed as a radical act of the will because in the actions which the will performs it makes a choice for. In love, the choice for is equated with a choice to. I choose to give myself in one way or another to a person.

Love has a reciprocal nature. The person loved needs to have a capacity to reciprocate the love. Hence, strictly speaking, one cannot speak of a man loving another animal (e.g. a dog). A dog does not have the capacity to reciprocate love because it does not have the will. Love is between persons. In addition, love does not imply sensation. It is true, *in the first phase towards love there may be an attraction to. This attraction can be physical. Normally this does not last for long.* Love has to go beyond the physical to the spiritual. I love that person not because of his/her physical beauty but also because of his intellectual and volitive beauty. Like is therefore not the same as love. Liking is purely physical and stays at this level. *Infatuation is a form of like.*

How does a person come to love?

Since love is an action of the will, it follows that for someone to love another person, the will has to be informed. To love a person, there is need to interact with a person; to know the person. This knowledge is first sensitive, conceptual and then reflexive. After I know the person I choose to give or not to give myself. Love therefore implies knowing the person- the likes and dislikes, weaknesses and strengths. Love is fostered with time and through time. It implies identification with the person loved. Indeed, *it is true in some sense to say someone becomes what he or she loves.* If Love is raised to a transcendental level and not merely at the natural level, it gains a transcendental value-an infinite value. The love of a spouse becomes eternal when their love is identified with everlasting love which is exclusive and total.

Love is a consequence of freedom. The freer a person is the more one can love, and the more one loves the more free one becomes. People who do not love or cannot love are people who have limited freedom. They cannot achieve true happiness. Let us now examine the different forms of love in society.

Forms of love

Love can be at the individual level, i.e. love of oneself or at the social level-love for the other. *Individual love or love of oneself is concupiscible love. At the social level, it is love for the other. Love for the other is benevolent love.*

Benevolent love is first experienced in a family setting. Spousal or marital love is prior to the society. A man and woman come together and decide to form a family. A number of families form a clan and eventually a political society.

If a person does not experience benevolent love in the family it is very difficult for that person to experience it in a political society or economic society since these societies value a person for what he gives and not necessarily what he is. *It is only in the family where a person is valued for who she/he is.*

Conclusion

Love in a family is demonstrated through not only procreation, but also education and nourishing the offspring. Love in an intermediate society is demonstrated implicitly by achieving the common aim of the society e.g. profits. Love in a political society is demonstrated through achieving and maintaining the common good. Our society today likes to create a conflict between individual good and common good. Some people cannot relate how the happiness of others relates to my own happiness. If in a society people are not happy; there are many inequalities in salary, wages, healthcare and social amenities. In such societies social evils arise like theft, murder and corruption. It is interesting to note that in these societies the rich end up spending a lot of money in private and public security. *Societies which have low crime rates are those with least inequalities.*

Let us examine the topic of human sexuality which is connected with the formation of the first interpersonal society, a family.

Chapter 8

My sexuality as part of my human identity

Introduction

The human body, oriented interiorly by the sincere gift of the person, reveals not only its masculinity or femininity on the physical plane, but reveals also such a value and such a beauty as to go beyond the purely physical dimension of sexuality. In this manner awareness of the nuptial meaning of the body, connected with man's masculinity-femininity, is in a way completed. On the one hand, this meaning indicates a particular capacity of expressing love, in which man becomes a gift. On the other hand, the capacity and deep availability for the affirmation of the person corresponds to it. This is, literally, the capacity of living the fact that the other—the woman for the man and the man for the woman (JohnPaul, 1980).

Interior innocence (that is, righteousness of intention) in the exchange of the gift consists in reciprocal "acceptance" of the other, such as to correspond to the essence of the gift. In this way, mutual donation creates the communion of persons. It is a question of "receiving" the other human being and "accepting" him. Therefore, the man not only accepts the gift. At the same time he is received as a gift by the woman, in the revelation of the interior spiritual essence of his masculinity, together with the whole truth of his body and sex. Accepted in this way, he is enriched through this acceptance and welcoming of the gift of his own masculinity. Subsequently, this acceptance, in which the man finds himself again through the sincere gift of himself, becomes in him the source of a new and deeper enrichment of the woman. The exchange is mutual. In it the reciprocal effects of the sincere gift and of the finding oneself again are revealed and grow (JohnPaul, 1980).

Human sexuality is unique because, it relates not only to the man and woman, but also to the parents and child. Hence it is sexual relations, not only of man to woman, but of child to parents, that found human community which alone the other biological needs are adequately met.

The Biological-Psychological Aspects

Human sexuality is remarkable in that, although fertility of the female is cyclical, their own human sexuality is governed by reason. As a result, a relatively permanent bonding of man and woman is a basic feature of sexual behaviour in all known human societies, and other varieties of sexual activity appear as variations on, not substitutes for this basic pattern. Nevertheless, what is unique to human parenting is not the mother child relation, which is more prolonged for humans, but otherwise much the same as in other mammals, but the father-child relation which hardly exists among animals, yet is of immense importance for the human species.

The biological function of the sexual differentiation of any species is not just reproduction, since that could be accomplished by asexual modes of procreation, but the recombination of genetic material in order (1) to achieve a rejuvenation of genetic transmission by a genetic balancing; (2) and perhaps more importantly to produce new genetic combinations from which natural selection can be made so as to promote further adaptation to environmental changes and thus to advance in the evolutionary process(Etkin, 1964).

From this need to recombine genetic materials has arisen a kind of division of labour for which the sexes have been differentiated and adapted: the female providing the ovum which must contain nutritional materials for the first stages of the embryological development and which is

therefore larger and less mobile, and the male providing the sperm which is small, mobile and able to seek out the ovum. The ovum and the sperm are equal in their genetic contribution to the new primary unit, except the male contributes a Y chromosome in about half of the cases of fertilisation thus producing males approximately equal to what otherwise would all be females. In mammals this division of labour serves the function of permitting the female to gestate the egg for a longer period within her own body and then to feed it from her breasts for even longer period so that embryological and infant development can be lengthened and thus a more complex organism, especially as regards the brain, can be built. This long period of gestation reaches its climax (allowing for differences in body size) in the human species for the formation of the brain. A male human body differs from females from the time of embryo development, which accentuates the differences. At birth, there is a clear difference between a male child and female child.

At birth, the female body is more receptive than the male's, hence more resistant to disease. The male is on the average physically larger and stronger (but perhaps less resistant to disease and shorter-lived) than the female, who has more markedly differentiated cerebral hemispheres, resulting in some moderate differences in psychological aptitudes, and seems to have some stronger aggressive drives. Furthermore, a woman's body is more united to her person than man is to his.

Woman is more practical. Personally, it is said that woman has more intuition, and that knowledge by intuition is superior to knowledge by reason. *Woman is more sensitive, obliging, compassionate, selfless, generous, constant, uniting, attractive, organizing, systemic, circumspective, etc. It all indicates that woman's spiritual powers, intelligence and will, are more united to the person than man's are.* In other words, woman is more united to her femininity than man is to his masculinity. Further, beauty is proper to woman, and beauty attracts and unites. This is true not only of exterior, but also and above all of interior beauty (Juan-Selles, 2010, p.125).

Nevertheless, males and females seem to be equal in fundamental intelligence, which makes functional sense in that both have to share substantially in the care of the children and in the transmission to the child of the cultural inheritance. *Females, who as mothers must understand the needs of small children before they can speak, seem more sensitive than males on non-verbal clues in personal relations but more facile in speech..*

Male and female organisms, much like man and woman as such, are different and asymmetric. *Man's person does not show up in his nature and essence. It is therefore said that man is more objective, meaning that the powers of nature and essence betray man's real being less.* For woman it is the opposite. *She manifests more what she really is in her thinking, loving and gesturing. Hence it is said that she is more subjective and therefore organizing, i.e. she takes other persons more into account.* That woman identifies more with her femininity than man with his virility happens at all levels: in the family, in affectivity, in social, cultural, academic, labour etc., relations (Juan-Selles, 2010, p.125).

When is human sexuality really human?

The condition of being a man or woman (sexuality) marks the biological, the spiritual, cultural and social aspect of the person. It affects all the dimensions of the person. *While sexuality is part of the personality of the individual, sex is merely a part of his/her corporeality.* Somehow

making a subtle distinction, we may say that sexuality, as a quality (masculinity and femininity), cannot be applied to animals, while sex (maleness and femaleness) can be.

Given the fact that human beings exist in two modalities – masculine and feminine –, fulfilment of the human person is not likely to be achieved without adequate sexual interaction. The sexual instinct in the case of man is broader than mere physical-corporal attraction. Nor can one reduce the understanding of human sexuality to its obvious procreative orientation. As a matter of fact, human sexuality is like a four-piece puzzle (Mimbi, 2007).

And which are the four pieces?

- i) The first is the differentiation of the sexes: to-be-man and to-be-woman. There is a division of mankind as a whole into two halves, each of which is seen as a complement to the other. *The man complements the woman and vice versa. Each has physical and psychological attributes which the other does not have.*
- ii) In effect, the second piece of the puzzle is mutual attraction of the two halves and their reciprocal complementariness. This dimension of human sexuality leads to the process of falling in love and union. *The mutual attraction is not only in terms of the soma (the physical aspect) but also the psychological aspect.* This is very important for the third piece of the puzzle.
- iii) The third is the communal and social dimension that characterises this union. This is the conjugal and family community that the attraction and complementariness lead to, as it were, of its own accord. *When the man is attracted to the woman, they decide to form a union. The union has three primary ends: unitive (they want to be one); procreative (they want the oneness to be reflected in an offspring[s]); educative and nutritive (they want to nourish and educate each other including the children).*
- iv) The fourth piece is the personal dimension of this union manifested in the free and loving relationship between the two persons. This is the most important and decisive of the pieces. It leads to the bond that galvanizes the two persons into an exclusive and permanent friendship. *In the family the child is able to perfect his personality. The husband also discovers specific human attributes in the woman which build him and the woman also discovers these human attributes. Each member of the family ends up developing their personalities.*

In the end family love is the inspiration of wider activities, but these wider activities rooted not just in human sexuality but in human personality. Hence culture must not define either the woman or the man simply in terms of their family roles, but also in terms of their social roles. The teleology of sexuality for the human being is not in itself a matter of free choice. It is one of the defining characteristics as to what it is to be human. To suppose that the goal is pleasure apart from committed love is to misunderstand what sex is all about and can in the end only lead to a distortion and frustration of authentic social fulfilment. The family provides the right environment where sexual love can grow to full maturity. We can thus say that human sexuality is really human when the nature & roles of man and woman are clearly understood, not as competitors but complementary (within the family and society).

Which are some of the wrong theories that proliferate the media and the contemporary world?

There are many wrong notions about human sexuality that have proliferated media. Some are as old as the ancient Greek civilization while some theories are fairly recent. This section will provide an overview of three wrong theories.

i) *Some view the role of human sexuality as pleasure*

Some individuals think that the aim of human sexuality is mere pleasure. The proponents of this view are Sigmund Freud and Carl G. Jung. Carl Jung reduces human sexuality into two aspects, the *anima* and *animus*. The *animus* is unconscious in woman and the *anima* is the unconscious principle in man. When the two meet each half is awakened, resulting into man becoming consciously androgynous. Hence a person is incomplete until there is a union with the opposite sex. Furthermore, in this particular case, sex exists not for reproduction but to satisfy a fundamental human need. *This theory is very limited because it focuses only on the physical aspects and does not take into consideration the procreative, educative and nutritive aspects of the union of man and woman. Under the unitive aspect, the reproductive role of sex is secondary and children are viewed as an obstacle.*

ii) *The erroneous metaphysical view of human sexuality*

This theory sees the origin of sex not in reproduction but in the bipolarity of the creator of man. God, in this theory, is bipolar and androgynous and his bipolarity is mirrored in creation by the differentiation of the sexes. *The error in this theory is that the Creator cannot be material, neither can one speak about God being bipolar since His Being and Act of Being are one. There is no potency in God (matter). Otherwise, the Supreme Being cannot be said to be perfect.*

iii) *The inspiration theory on human sexuality*

The function of sexuality for the proponents of this theory is not reproduction but the stimulation of human creativity and to cultural advancement. This theory is as old as Plato and was renewed in medieval chivalry, especially during the Romantic period. *The limitation of this theory is that Human Sexuality is not for the purpose of human creativity but to propagate the human race. A person does not become more creative through human sexuality.*

Conclusion

Love is a radical feature of both man and the family. It is at the origin of every family, the centre whence the family is born. The natural family is born of personal love and is the first manifestation of personal love. Its aim is personal love. Family at the natural level is a manifestation of the family at the personal level. Person is love; to love a person means to value him as he actually is, i.e. in its being. In the family, every member is loved for what he/she is. To understand personal love, one has to see the family as the natural way of understanding love, because the family is that unique place where each one is loved because he/she is, no matter what or how he/she is. From the spiritual identification (immaterial identification) there emerges the awareness of the union through the body, in safeguarding the interior freedom of the gift. Through the affectionate manifestations the couple help each other remain faithful to the union. At the same time these manifestations protect in each of them that deep-rooted peace which is in a certain sense the interior resonance of chastity guided by the gift of respect for what God creates.

This gift involves a profound and universal attention to the person in one's masculinity and femininity, thus creating the interior climate suitable for personal communion. Sexuality, by

means of which man and woman give themselves to one another through the acts which are proper and exclusive to spouses, is by no means something purely biological, but concerns the innermost being of the human person as such. It is realized in a truly human way only if it is an integral part of the love by which a man and a woman commit themselves totally until death. The total physical self-giving would be a lie if it were not the sign and fruit of a total personal self-giving, in which the whole person, including the temporal dimension, is present: if the person were to withhold something or reserve the possibility of deciding otherwise in the future, by this very fact he or she would not be giving totally(JohnPaul, 1981).

Chapter 9

I am because we are!(Ubuntu)

Introduction

Man is zoon politikon- a political animal. When individuals are born, they realize they have parents. The development of a child requires the involvement of mother and father. *A child already starts to relate with the mother, father or guardian. The person is an inter-personal being. The closest relations are between family, close relatives and friends.* Interpersonal relations need time, effort and patience to nurture and maintain. These relations make a person happy. *Generally, a person reacts to what the other person is perceiving, feeling, and thinking in addition to what the other person may be doing (Heider, 2013).*

Definition

An inter-personal relation is an association between two or more individuals. The association may be based on inference, love, solidarity, regular business interactions, or some other type of social commitment. Interpersonal relationships are formed in the context of social, cultural and other influences. At the highest level of these inter-personal relations we have the *polis*, the state, which is responsible for ensuring the common good.

Where does politics fit into all this? Can't we do without politics?

Politics is the only way that can lead to excellence when it comes to community life. Politics, as shall be discussed in another unit-Social and Political Philosophy, deals with the common good, conceptions of the common good and the good life (eudemonia). The political institution, as an institution is not created by man but arises due to man's nature. Although men can come together in order to provide their own basic necessities, the community provides conditions through which man can develop his intellectual, moral and physical virtues to help one realize his nature. In his nature, man cannot do without politics. Our discussion will now focus on the person in the different forms of society.

A society is therefore the unfailing manifestation of human coexistence according to types, subject to different alternatives in so far as they are human.

There are four important elements in the definition of society: i) *a society is an unfailing manifestation*, meaning where a human being is, she/he needs a society. A person cannot fail to be with others no matter how individualistic the person is; ii) *in the relation with others, there can be different types of societies*. This is explained in the next paragraph; iii) *any society implies human co-existence or formation of social bonds*. Individual actions are also social actions. What I do as a person has an influence on other persons I co-exist (associate) with; iv) *there are various alternatives which a person can freely choose to become a member of*. A person should not be forced to become a member of a particular society. Free association is part of human nature.

There are different types of societies: a) natural societies; b) artificial societies. As the name suggests, *natural societies* are linked to nature. These societies occur naturally and its aims are natural. The laws which govern such societies emanate from nature, for instance natural moral law. Examples of natural societies include: families; political communities.

Artificial societies are different kinds of societies which he forms voluntarily and it's not necessary that such societies be formed. The aims of these societies are determined by the members and the laws which govern such societies are agreed upon by the members. An example of an artificial society is a sports club or a company.

Societies are structured in basic and fundamental ways. *The primary society is the family*, which was covered in the previous chapter. The family is the most basic society and is its nucleus. *There are other societies which are between the family and the political community, these are the intermediate societies*. An example of an intermediate society is a school, university or a business. The highest society is the political community, e.g. the state. Though some scholars have tried to provide other societies which are higher than the state, the state can choose to belong to these or not, for instance a political federation like the African Union. The table below provides an overview societies structured according to levels, their nature, aims and laws.

Level	Nature	Aim, end or purpose	Laws governing it
Family	Natural	Unity, procreation, education and nutrition	Natural moral law
Intermediate society	Artificial	Decided by the members e.g. education in the case of a school	Artificial laws e.g. statutes
Political community e.g. State	Natural	Common good	Constitution which has the bill or rights (natural) and other chapters.

Political societies, intermediate societies and families are governed by specific philosophies. The term *philosophy* has been used in a loose way in this case to mean way of life. A political society can ascribe to a capitalist philosophy or socialist philosophy. An individual can have specific views on how he should relate with others, for instance Kierkegaard an existentialist believed that the only person who matter is the person and God. *For him, he believed that a person should be cautious of having interaction with others*(Chakravarti & Roy, April- July 2002). *All these views have to be evaluated against the metaphysical definition of man*. Their falsity and truthfulness lies in their lack of expression or clarity in the view of man.

Human relationships in different societies, cultures and philosophies

Like any living creature, human nature in its concrete form consists of male and female, man and woman. In ancient Greece, philosophers like Plato emphasized that neither man nor woman alone possess the whole of human nature, each is only a part of the ideal human being. According to Plato, love (eros) between man and woman is a natural tendency in which the parts of the original anthropos seek one another. Thus, the act of eros is a reunion of the human being which in its original status (namely, in the world of ideas) was one. It was divided into two parts only because of the incarnation of the human soul into the sensible world, like one condemned to a prison or entombed after death. Hence, the primordial sense of interpersonal relationships as interpersonal love between a man and a woman(Kun-Yu, 2014).

In the Middle Ages, when Christianity became dominant in the West, people understood that according to the Old Testament woman was a part of man. Hence, marriage was elevated to a sacrament in which the couple received the blessing from God through the Church. Where the philosophy of Plato saw "eros" as the way back to primordial human nature, Jesus Christ gave his disciples "charity" as the greatest commandment. "To love one another" was to be the sign of Christians and interpersonal relationships would be the essential way to perfection for all believers(Kun-Yu, 2014).

In China, although there was neither a Platonic theory about man and woman nor any religious sacrament for marriage, nevertheless the origin of man and woman was discussed thoroughly in the Book of Change: "Chi'en-Tao accomplished man, whereas Kun-Tao accomplished woman." The ancient Chinese sages sought the archetype of both man and woman in the primordial substance of Tao; it is only Tao's different attributes that make the difference in human nature. Tao is the fullness of life; the re-union of man and woman participates in the same living force, which is "the generative act-process without end." In Chinese traditional culture, the family system has been accepted and respected throughout most of history. The natural binary force, Yin and Yang, signifies not only a generative dynamism, but also the prototype and example for the human couple: husband and wife. Begetting numerous children symbolizes a virtuous, happy life and is a divine blessing. In ancient China society cannot be understood apart from the notion of family with its consanguineous relations(Kun-Yu, 2014).

Recently, solidarity has been proposed as a promising compromise. This would not leave human nature in its original, naive status. The relation between the individual and others should not be left to natural impulses, not should an artificial mixture of the two be attempted. Rather, solidarity would raise persons above the stage of nature, beyond merely naive impulses and enable them by intelligence and freedom to select what is a duty (or "ought") in accord with the moral law and its obligations. From the viewpoint of solidarity this higher stage is the place not of the *homo naturalis*, but of the *homo ethicus*. (Kun-Yu, 2014). *Any social and political society, if it is to flourish needs to spread its culture. We **can say that man is not only a political animal but a cultural animal**. One's culture determines a person's identity. Let us examine what culture is and its various elements which foster interpersonal relations.*

What does it mean to be cultured?

Definition

*Culture is the interiorization and enrichment by means of learning. It is also a totality of customs, techniques and values that distinguish a social group. Culture has its etymology in the Latin word *cultus*, which refers to the rearing or growing of something.*

*A cultured person is one who has interiorized and enriched his personality. A cultured person is able to learn from others and bring out (educate) the best part from the different cultures and or individuals. To say a person is cultured may be equivalent to saying a person is educated, since education originates from the word *e-educare* (to educate).*

According to Rembrandt, culture is the mode of living proper to a society. A cultured person knows how to read into the great works of man and therein discover riches hitherto unknown to the ignorant. Culture therefore has to perfect man as man.

Culture gives a person his/her identity. There are dominant cultures and sub-cultures. We will not discuss these two in this unit.

Culture has different elements

Culture has different elements. The fundamental elements of culture are: language; norms; government; art, dressing; work; beliefs or tradition; stories and narratives; education (a system of formation); social systems.

The Maasai culture is identified by: the Maasai language, specific ways of relating with each other (norms), are ruled by specific elders (government), have specific modes of dressing and have art pieces, are nomads (work), have a system of initiation and education and their societies are structured in specific ways amongst families and clans.

In order for any society to flourish, it needs to develop its own culture. A society without culture is a society tending towards extinction. In a business setting, there is need to have a culture which the employees can identify with, either through: speaking in English; having rules which govern their relations; having a clear chain of command; having a consistent form of dressing and continuous development (education). A family and nation state also needs to develop its own culture.

Language is a very important cultural element. Language has to express thought. Language has to be truthful (veracity). A society in which people do not communicate clearly is a society which has many interpersonal frictions. Language can either be through body language, sign language, visual or audio form. Language enables work in a society. People who speak in different languages may not be able to efficiently work together. It is therefore important to have one language of communication in a society. Communication can be between two persons-dyadic, within a group (group communication) or within an organisational set-up.

Work on the other hand, enables man perfect himself. Work is an exquisitely human affair. Animals do not work either, because with whatever they do they neither improve nor worsen their animal situation. Any man, on the other hand, improves or worsens by working, or by not working at all. If I do not work I become less of a human and vice-versa. But work ought to be subordinated to language, to society and to ethics, because it is these three that make work possible. Human work is a transitive action, but isolated from truthful language and ethics becomes meaningless. To work is a right, because it is the channel for human development and creativity. Man needs more than just to subsist; he needs to improve himself, society and the world by working. Work, then, is the most expressive form of man's total essence. Work acquires a personal sense only if understood as a gift of oneself to others. And since to give is related to receiving, work is personal if what is accepted is not only the service but also the person offering it. A piece of work is more personal when it is asked personally and received directly from the other person. That is why it is important to put a value to one's work, first because the product created has an imprint of the person who works and consequently he/she deserves a just remuneration from it. It is important to have a just pay for workers since this is what sustains creativity and self giving.

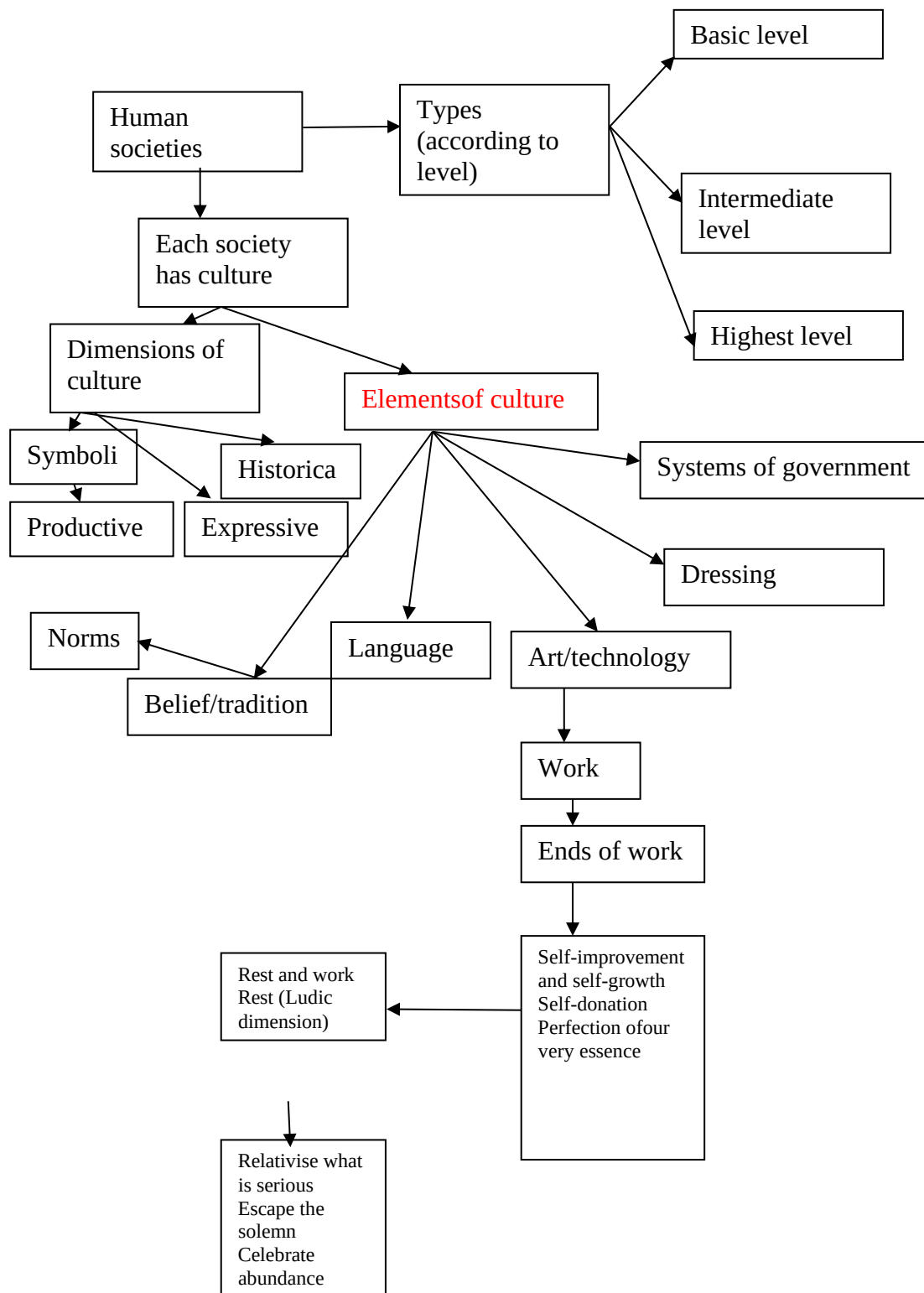
Work needs to be combined with rest or leisure. A person works in view of relaxation. In Philosophical terms, leisure and relaxation is referred to as the Ludic dimension. I work now because I know that after some months I will go for leave. Rest or leisure acquires meaning only when it is connected to work. Leisure enables a person: i) to free oneself from the solemn

or serious. A person is able to laugh and enjoy; ii) show super-abundance. One can only rest if he has extra money and time to spare. Hence it is a fruit of a hard-earned effort; iii) celebrate the completion of a task. Therefore celebrations like anniversaries acquire meaning; iv) escape dreariness. One needs to take a break from the normal world with its own laws and regulations into another world (a playful world).

Dimensions of culture

The elements of culture have four dimensions. **Some elements of culture express what a culture is. This is the expressive dimension.** An example is language or art. **Other elements of culture have some historical dimension.** Tradition, stories and narratives transmit history. **Work, dressing and art have some symbolic meaning-symbolic dimension.** Specific art and dressing can symbolize happiness, marriage or even funerals. **The productive dimension** represents what a specific culture has developed. This is mainly through education and work.

Concept map representing culture and human societies



Current issues which affect inter-personal relations

Today's world is a fast paced world with technology determining the direction of many sectors. New social networking tools like Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Whatsapp enables people to interact freely while at a distance. These tools, good as they are, are a means to specific ends and are not specific ends in themselves. Facebook for instance can be used to supplement the face-to-face contact but not to replace it. Once these forms of technology become an end in themselves, it may lead to technocentrism with the many disastrous effects. Man ends up being placed at the service of technology. There are many people who spend many hours on social networking sites and do not go out to meet friends. They may have an illusion that they have a great circle of friends in their social networking sites, while in reality they have few or none. Friendship implies spending quality time with someone, having that face to face contact; speaking to someone and sharing a meal or a joke...in short getting to know someone and the other person knowing you.

Technology can also be used for the sole purpose of making a profit and not to humanize a person. This leads to technocracy. The consequences of this new type of culture (technocracy) are frightening, even paralysing. On the material level, technocracy continues to provoke a very grave energy crisis, which renders the future of humanity very obscure and uncertain, and which can result in a lack of prime materials that will end up much worse than the preceding shortages that have afflicted humanity. Already, there is talk of the world running out of hydrocarbons in a relatively short period of time. It is our hope that human ingenuity will work out another source of (renewable) energy. Technology thus has to be used in a human way and needs to humanize a person. It is our role to ensure that technology is used as a humanizing tool.

Conclusion

We need to be able to cultivate human relations in all types of societies. We cannot develop knowledge necessary to act morally in society unless we have been in intimate relationships. No one knows how to do mathematics or to play football without acquaintance with the discipline or the game. The same is generally true of any attempt to promote the interests of others. Someone reared by uncaring parents, who never established close personal ties with others, will simply not know how to look after or promote the interests of intimates or strangers. We cannot promote interests we cannot identify, and the way we learn to identify the interests of others is by interacting with them. For instance, most of us learned from our families how to recognize the needs of others. There is a strong correlation between the extent of a person's involvement in close relationships and the extent of her ability and motivation to care for strangers. That is, if we have had several close relationships, we will learn how to best respond to different intimates' needs in a variety of circumstances. Our moral horizons will be opened up by such encounters. We must learn ways people suffer -- ways which had previously escaped our attention. We can learn how to ease their suffering. And we will learn the myriad ways to promote the interests of others (LaFollette, 1996, p. 208).

Chapter 10

What is the end of the human person?

Introduction

What is the end of the human person? Where does a person go after he dies? What conclusions can we develop first from an individual psychosomatic perspective and then from a social perspective? Any philosopher, after investigating the ultimate cause of reality will ask these fundamental questions. *The intricate answers to these questions can only be given if we have a deep metaphysical understanding of man, and consequently develop an epistemology which reflects man in his entirety.* A materialistic view of man ends up adopting a pessimistic and doomed answer to these questions.

Man is human because of his intelligence. Its development progresses step by step beyond the body matter and into the spiritual sphere. In interpersonal relations, which are oriented mainly towards spiritual intersubjectivity, the spiritual life of human existence created the history of humankind. This includes not only the natural sciences through which all the necessities of man's daily life such as food, clothes, home, and transportation advance day by day, but morals, arts and religion which also flourish. All social constructions are under the control of morality for in them human nature is more than a process of scientific technology: artistic and religious feelings lift human nature from the natural to supernatural life.

Our memory and our hope

The corporeal man exists in time. Time in itself is *a measure of change, is irreversible and is concretised in uniform movement.* The present soon becomes past, and each passing minute brings us to a closer realization of the loss of our corporality, our psychosomatic nature. *Hope becomes a lamp which burns brightly in the face of this abyss of darkness. But is this hope fallacious?*

Hope relates to the fulfilment and search for a future good. To hope is to look forward with desire and usually with a measure of confidence in the likelihood of gaining what is desired. The confidence is grounded on the memory of past experience.

Hope, in its widest acceptance, is described as the desire of something together with the expectation of obtaining it. The Scholastics say that it is a movement of the appetite towards a future good, which though hard to attain, is not impossible to achieve with God's help. Without the future one's life is rendered flat. Memory and hope gives us an aim opened before us by eternity.

Man's life is meaningless without hope. Without the search for meaning, the present, past and future do not make sense.

In the previous topics, we explained that man has the immaterial and material dimension, the *psyche and soma*. Death is the separation of the soul and the body. Since the body is material, it corrupts and disappears. The soul is immaterial and therefore can exist beyond the body. *Once such a deduction is made, some*

questions which arise are: what happens to the soul? Is there another world? Where does the soul go? For Plato, the answers to the questions are: there is a Maker, the soul which is the form goes to the maker and there is another world a world of forms. A similar conclusion was reached by our fore-fathers. The traditional African communities, the Egyptians had a common idea of life after death. This means that the existence of the soul, of the after life and a Maker is not only a matter in the realm of religion, but can also be approached Philosophically.

Let us briefly examine the Philosophical proofs of the existence of a maker

Thomas Aquinas postulated five proofs for the existence of a Supreme Maker, an Unmoved Mover, a God. These proofs are:

Proof of the existence of God through the necessity and contingency argument: The arguments are as follows: we see that the created universe is made up of contingent beings [Beings which exist at one time and another time they cease to be]. A certain rose flower may be there today but withers after one week. This means that there has to be a being, outside the flower that holds it in the state of flower(ing). This being has to be necessary, since if it were contingent like the flower everything would cease to exist if the flower dies, or if it stops to exist before the flower. This means that the Supreme Being has to be a necessary being. The Being is always there. The necessary being does not have any trace of potency or becoming, but is pure act.

Proof of the existence of God through gradation: When we observe life, living organisms and non-living, we realize that it is arranged according to specific grades. The non-organic is lower than the plant life, the plant life is lower than the animal life and the animal life is lower than human life. For there to be grades, there has to be a cause of this gradation. As experience shows us, this cause of grades is not man, but is superior to man. This shows that there has to be an intelligent being, a mind behind the cause of grades. We realize this is not man since man finds gradation in the universe. There has been another intelligent Maker other than man.

Proof of the existence of a Supreme Maker, God through the teleological argument: when we observe nature, we realize that anything that is, has a specific nature and end. The end or nature of created beings has not been caused by those beings. Man does not decide his nature or end, she/he finds himself with specific nature which determines her/his rational actions. Since all created beings have a specific end or nature which they do not decide, there has to be a cause of this end or nature. That is a Being whose very nature is and is its very end-the Creator. Thus the Creator is the ultimate telos (end) of all that exists.

Proof of the existence of God through order: Linked to the teleological argument is the argument of order. Order points to intelligence. As one observes the cosmos, the earth, seas and all that is in it including the stars and the galaxies, one cannot but be shocked at seeing order. For order to be there, there has to be intelligence behind the order. Chaos cannot be the cause of order. Chaos cannot but lead to Chaos. Intelligence is always the cause of order. This leads to a being, outside our cosmos who is the very cause of the order-the Creator or God.

Proof of the existence of God through the moral argument: In man, we see a law in accord with his nature which determines all men to act within specific fundamental morals. For instance, by nature man realizes that it is wrong to kill because it is contrary to his nature, unless he is protecting his/her own nature. This law, this principle is not material, yet it is within each human species. The UN Charter's preamble states that the right to life is the most fundamental right.

Morals, the rightness and wrongness of human actions are not material, and hence it implies there has to be a certain immaterial order, which acts as the law giver-a Maker of the principle.

There are other arguments which have been postulated, for example the ontological argument.

Need to relate with the Creator

Once proofs for the immateriality of the soul (spirituality of the soul) and existence of a Creator have been postulated, the next issue is how does man relate with this Creator?

The relation with the Creator emanates naturally. Man is naturally a religious being. Religion comes from the Latin word *Religare* which means to bind. Man binds himself to a supreme Creator. He realizes that the Creator is eternal and has the most perfect kind of life. *All religions have the following common acts: prayers, sacrifices, morality on the basis of which there is eternal remuneration and dogma.*

Since Philosophy uses common sense experience and the senses corrupt when a person dies, we realize that the discussion of the after life needs to be tackled by another field using other methods and sources. Nevertheless, the deductions we reach with our reason, through *Philosophy*, cannot and should not contradict *these other methods- Theology*. Theology is a Science which studies God and which uses supernatural or divine Revelation as its source.

Conclusion

In reality the only subsistent part in man is the soul. But man, for him to be perfect, also needs the body [the soul is naturally united to the body because it is essentially its form]. Nature reveals to us that it is against nature for something to continue existing against its nature. It is unnatural for the soul to continue existing without the body, since nothing that goes against nature can exist perpetually. Since the soul exists perpetually, it is necessary that it be reunited with its body, and this is resurrection. The immortality of the (human) soul would seem to require the future resurrection of the body. So, man's origin and destiny are wrapped in mystery. This brings us to the consideration that death was not planned as part of man's life on earth; rather, we can see it as something evil which has been provoked by man himself. In this view, death would have a penal nature, as a penalty imposed on us due to having committed a crime. This is the understanding of death as offered by religion, according to which, death is not an absolute evil, but rather, a relative evil; it is a punishment that we must suffer in order to restore us to our original state as immortal beings.

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